

ENGLISH FOR THE CAFE COUNTER

Baristas and Cafe Staff English

Precise orders. Better conversations.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.



Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For baristas, cafe counter staff, shift leads, and customer-facing coffee teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight cafe conversations: clarify a drink order, compare textures, handle an allergy question, match a pickup, correct a label, discuss gift coffee, explain a combo price, and hand over the bar.

01 Taking a precise drink order

4

What does regular mean? | Separate size, temperature, and coffee choice, then give a concise read-back before the drink is made.

02 Comparing drinks without overclaiming

13

Less foam, not more caffeine | Compare drinks on the requested feature while distinguishing texture, espresso serving, and unsupported caffeine claims.

03 Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

22

Oat does not settle the question | Acknowledge an allergy, preserve the separate modification, and route the actual product and preparation questions for checking.

04 Managing the queue and pickup

31

Two customers named Sam | Interrupt a mistaken pickup politely, match the ticket and drink, and explain readiness without inventing a wait.

05 Handling remakes and mistaken labels

40

The label is not the ticket | Identify an order-label mismatch, request a checked remake, and keep timing and payment decisions separate.

06 Discussing coffee beans for home

49

Before the beans are ground | Clarify the intended brewer, explain sensory wording, and avoid an irreversible choice based on an ambiguous request.

07 Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

58

The combo and the upcharge | Explain the complete comparison, retain an applicable upcharge, and offer a confirmed available item without pressure.

08 Handing over the bar and till

67

One order, three unfinished items | Transfer drink, stock, and cash-check responsibilities while preserving the difference between counted, pending, and signed off.

Communication field notes

3

Answers and explanations

76

Fast-access phrase pages

92

Vocabulary index

94

Sources and publication notes

102

Translate the menu into a clear choice.

Cafe shorthand is useful among colleagues but can confuse customers. Ask one precise question at a time, explain a comparison using the actual recipe, and keep the order details connected to the right cup.

Ask what the word means

Regular can describe a size, a coffee choice, or a familiar order. Check the intended meaning before using your own cafe convention.

"By regular, do you mean our middle size or non-decaf coffee?"

Compare one feature at a time

Foam, milk, espresso serving, flavor intensity, and caffeine are different features. Use the supplied recipe and avoid turning a texture comparison into an unsupported health or caffeine claim.

"These two small drinks use the same espresso serving; the latte has less foam."

Match the order, not just the name

A name can belong to more than one customer. Read back the ticket number and drink details, and separate a completed item from an order that is still in progress.

"Ticket 67: large iced decaf latte. That one is still being made."

Say what remains unchecked

An allergy query, remake time, grind request, or till reconciliation may still need a check. Explain the next step and keep a proposed action distinct from a finished result.

"I will check the current product and preparation arrangements with our lead."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All cafes, recipes, tickets, prices, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not food-safety certification, medical advice, equipment operation, or cash-control procedures. Follow actual product information, local requirements, workplace allergen controls, equipment instructions, and payment rules. No example authorizes serving an unverified drink or bypassing a required check.

What does regular mean?

A Read the situation

Separate size, temperature, and coffee choice, then give a concise read-back before the drink is made.

At this fictional cafe, regular is the middle cup size. Customer Alex asks for a regular latte, meaning non-decaf coffee rather than a particular size. Barista Nia has not started the drink. When asked separately, Alex chooses a small hot latte, non-decaf, with the standard dairy milk and no syrup, to take away. The task is to resolve the ambiguous word without correcting the customer as if there were one universal cafe vocabulary. No price, exact temperature, or caffeine quantity is supplied.

PEOPLE / Nia: Barista | Alex: Customer

A CLARIFICATION CAN SOUND WELCOMING

A short either-or question is often easier to answer than a list of technical terms. Explain your local size name without suggesting the customer used English incorrectly. Confirm choices in the same order each time so the read-back is easy to follow.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does regular mean on this cafe menu?

- A** Small everywhere
- B** The only available milk
- C** The middle size
- D** A universal caffeine amount

2. What did Alex initially mean?

- A** A middle-size cup
- B** An iced drink
- C** An extra espresso serving
- D** Non-decaf coffee

3. Which order is confirmed?

- A** Middle iced decaf latte
- B** Large hot latte with vanilla
- C** Small iced latte with oat drink
- D** Small hot non-decaf latte, standard dairy milk, no syrup, takeaway

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

barista

Worker who prepares and serves coffee drinks.

IN USE ask the barista

drink order

Specified beverage and selected variations.

IN USE confirm the drink order

cup size

Named or measured capacity option for a drink.

IN USE clarify the cup size

regular

Context-dependent label that may describe size or coffee choice.

IN USE clarify regular

small

Cafe-defined size below its larger options.

IN USE order a small latte

hot

Prepared as a hot drink rather than an iced version.

IN USE confirm hot or iced

iced

Served with ice according to the drink recipe.

IN USE make an iced latte

non-decaf

Coffee not sold as decaffeinated.

IN USE specify non-decaf coffee

decaf

Coffee processed to remove most caffeine, not necessarily all.

IN USE request decaf

latte

Espresso-based drink with milk; proportions depend on the recipe.

IN USE order a latte

espresso

Concentrated coffee brewed by forcing hot water through ground coffee under pressure.

IN USE prepare espresso

shot

Cafe serving of espresso, with size defined by its recipe.

IN USE confirm the shot count

Precision check

Regular is not a reliable substitute for a complete order. In this cafe it names a size, but Alex means non-decaf. Ask which meaning is intended, then confirm the remaining choices separately.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

standard milk

Milk used by default in a particular recipe.

IN USE identify the standard milk

dairy milk

Milk from an animal source rather than a plant-based drink.

IN USE specify dairy milk

plant-based drink

Beverage made from plant ingredients and used as a milk alternative.

IN USE check a plant-based drink

syrup

Liquid flavoring or sweetener added to a drink.

IN USE omit the syrup

modifier

Order detail that changes the standard item.

IN USE enter the modifier

takeaway

Order intended to be taken away from the premises.

IN USE mark as takeaway

for here

Order intended for consumption on the premises.

IN USE ask for here or to go

read-back

Spoken repetition used to confirm the received order.

IN USE give a read-back

clarifying question

Question that resolves a specific uncertainty.

IN USE ask a clarifying question

size convention

Local system for naming cup sizes.

IN USE explain the size convention

order entry

Recording of the selected item and its details.

IN USE check the order entry

preparation start

Point at which making the drink begins.

IN USE confirm before preparation start

Precision check

A shot is a recipe-defined serving, not a universal caffeine quantity. Keep small, hot, non-decaf, milk choice, and syrup choice separate. None of those words alone supplies the price or an exact caffeine amount.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

RESOLVE THE FIRST WORD

"When you say regular, do you mean size or non-decaf?"

ASK FOR SIZE

"Would you like small, regular, or large?"

CONFIRM COFFEE CHOICE

"Non-decaf coffee, correct?"

CHECK SYRUP

"Any syrup, or none?"

EXPLAIN THE LOCAL LABEL

"Here, regular is our middle size."

SEPARATE TEMPERATURE

"Would you like that hot or iced?"

ASK ABOUT MILK

"Would you like our standard dairy milk?"

CHECK DESTINATION

"Is that for here or to take away?"

Regular versus standard

Both depend on local context; name the feature each describes.

Separate questions

Ask size and temperature separately when the original order is ambiguous.

Non-decaf

This describes the coffee choice without inventing a caffeine quantity.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REPEAT THE CORE ORDER

"One small hot latte with non-decaf coffee."

CONFIRM THE MILK

"Standard dairy milk for this order."

PAUSE PREPARATION

"I will confirm the details before we make it."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CLARIFICATION

"Thanks; I understand which meaning you intended."

KEEP THE OMISSION EXPLICIT

"No syrup in that one."

INVITE A CORRECTION

"Have I got all of that right?"

CORRECT THE SIZE

"Small, not our regular size."

CLOSE THE READ-BACK

"Small, hot, non-decaf, standard milk, no syrup, takeaway."

No syrup

An explicit omission is easier to preserve than an assumed default.

For here or to go

To go is a common US alternative to takeaway.

Read-back rhythm

Group the item first, then size, temperature, and modifications.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question directly resolves the ambiguity?

- A** Shall I make the usual?
- B** Is regular always hot?
- C** Do you mean our middle size or non-decaf coffee?
- D** You mean medium, obviously?

2. Which statement overclaims?

- A** Regular is our middle size here.
- B** Alex wants a small drink.
- C** The drink has not been started.
- D** Non-decaf tells me the exact caffeine quantity.

3. Which correction preserves Alex's request?

- A** Iced because the order changed.
- B** Small, not regular size; still non-decaf.
- C** Regular size, now decaf.
- D** Large because regular was ambiguous.

4. Why read the order back?

- A** To verify the combined choices before preparation
- B** To guarantee a serving time
- C** To establish a price not listed
- D** To replace the need for any product checks

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

What does regular mean?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

non-decaf / small / read-back / takeaway / regular / dairy milk / no syrup / hot or iced / order entry / size convention

- 01 **Alex:** Could I have a regular latte to take away, please? I am not sure what you call the sizes on this menu.
- 02 **Nia:** Certainly. When you say ¹ _____, do you mean our middle size, or do you mean non-decaf coffee? We use that word for size here.
- 03 **Alex:** I meant normal coffee rather than decaf. I do not need a big cup; the smallest latte would be enough for me.
- 04 **Nia:** Thanks, that helps. I will enter a ² _____ latte. The coffee choice is separate, so I will keep that as you requested.
- 05 **Alex:** Good. I sometimes end up with more coffee than I wanted because I use the same word for two different things.
- 06 **Nia:** It is easily mixed up. Would you like that ³ _____? I have not started making it, so we can confirm everything first.
- 07 **Alex:** Hot, please. I am taking it outside, and I would like something warm rather than a drink with ice in it.
- 08 **Nia:** A hot latte, understood. For the coffee, I have ⁴ _____. I am repeating that separately so it does not get confused with our size names.
- 09 **Alex:** Yes, that is right. What milk comes in it normally? I do not want to accidentally order a different version.
- 10 **Nia:** Our standard recipe uses ⁵ _____. Would you like that, or would you like to discuss one of the other options?

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Alex:** The standard milk is fine for this order. I would also like it without any syrup; I prefer it without added flavoring.
- 12 **Nia:** I have entered ⁶ _____. That is separate from the milk selection, and I will include both in the final read-back.
- 13 **Alex:** Thank you. I am not ordering a vanilla latte or anything like that, just the small hot latte we have been discussing.
- 14 **Nia:** Yes. And you said ⁷ _____, rather than drinking it here. I will make sure that is attached to the same order.
- 15 **Alex:** Correct. Can you repeat the whole thing once? I think we have settled it, but I would rather catch a mistake now.
- 16 **Nia:** Here is the ⁸ _____: one small hot latte, non-decaf coffee, standard dairy milk, no syrup, to take away. Have I got that right?
- 17 **Alex:** Yes, exactly. So small is the size, and what I called regular meant the coffee choice. That makes sense now.
- 18 **Nia:** Exactly. Our ⁹ _____ is small, regular, and large. You have chosen small; I have not changed your coffee choice.
- 19 **Alex:** Perfect. Thanks for checking rather than assuming I wanted the middle cup. That is all I would like to order today.
- 20 **Nia:** You are welcome. The ¹⁰ _____ now matches that read-back, so the bar can work from the confirmed details when preparing your drink.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. regular | 2. small | 3. hot or iced | 4. non-decaf | 5. dairy milk | 6. no syrup | 7. takeaway | 8. read-back | 9. size convention | 10. order entry

Confirm a different ambiguous order

F Say it

Customer Jo means decaf when saying regular coffee. After separate questions, Jo chooses a large iced latte with oat drink. Use these four confirmed details.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

decaf / large / oat drink / iced

Barista: "The coffee choice is ¹ _____."

Customer: "The size should be ² _____."

Barista: "The drink should be ³ _____."

Customer: "Please use ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. decaf | 2. large | 3. iced | 4. oat drink

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Less foam, not more caffeine

A Read the situation

Compare drinks on the requested feature while distinguishing texture, espresso serving, and unsupported caffeine claims.

Customer Morgan is choosing between the small latte and small cappuccino at this fictional cafe. Both recipes use the same espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam; the latte has more liquid milk. Morgan wants less foam, not an extra espresso serving or a claim about caffeine. Barista Sora must explain the practical difference and recommend the option matching that preference. The recipes describe this cafe only. No laboratory caffeine measurement, universal cup proportion, or health recommendation is supplied.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Customer | Sora: Barista

EXPLAIN THE CONTRAST THE CUSTOMER NEEDS

Specialist vocabulary can help when it answers a specific question. Start with the visible difference, such as more foam or more liquid milk. Add terms like texture only after connecting them to the customer preference. Avoid making taste sound objectively better or worse.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which feature does Morgan want less of?

- A Caffeine established by measurement
- C Liquid milk

- B Espresso servings
- D Foam

2. What is the same in both recipes?

- A Every cafe recipe worldwide
- C The amount of foam

- B The espresso serving
- D The amount of liquid milk

3. Which option matches the stated preference?

- A An extra-shot order not requested
- C The small latte

- B No option can be compared
- D The small cappuccino because it has more foam

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cappuccino

Espresso drink with milk and foam, made to a particular cafe recipe.

IN USE compare the cappuccino

foam

Aerated layer or texture containing bubbles in milk or another liquid.

IN USE reduce the foam

liquid milk

Milk considered separately from its aerated foam.

IN USE compare liquid milk

microfoam

Milk foam with very small bubbles and a smooth texture.

IN USE describe microfoam

texture

How a drink feels in the mouth.

IN USE compare the texture

mouthfeel

Sensation of a drink in the mouth beyond its flavor.

IN USE describe the mouthfeel

body

Perceived weight or fullness of a drink.

IN USE describe the body

flavor intensity

Perceived strength of taste or aroma.

IN USE compare flavor intensity

caffeine content

Amount of caffeine in a specified quantity or serving.

IN USE avoid guessing caffeine content

espresso serving

Recipe-defined amount of prepared espresso used in a drink.

IN USE use the same espresso serving

shot count

Number of recipe-defined espresso servings requested.

IN USE confirm the shot count

milk proportion

Share of a drink made up by milk.

IN USE compare the milk proportion

Precision check

More foam does not mean more espresso. Here, the two small recipes contain the same espresso serving. Match the requested texture without promising an exact caffeine amount or making claims about every cafe.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

recipe basis

Specified formulation used for a comparison.

IN USE state the recipe basis

like-for-like

Comparing items on the same relevant basis.

IN USE make a like-for-like comparison

small size

Cafe-defined smaller serving used in this comparison.

IN USE compare the small size

aeration

Incorporation of air into a liquid.

IN USE describe milk aeration

steam wand

Machine part used to introduce steam into milk.

IN USE identify the steam wand

milk pitcher

Vessel used to hold milk during preparation.

IN USE identify the milk pitcher

crema

Foam-like surface layer produced on espresso during extraction.

IN USE distinguish crema from milk foam

extraction

Transfer of soluble coffee compounds into brewing water.

IN USE discuss extraction

concentration

Amount of a substance relative to the quantity of liquid.

IN USE distinguish concentration from serving amount

extra shot

Additional espresso serving beyond the recipe.

IN USE request an extra shot

preference

Customer's stated choice or desired feature.

IN USE match the preference

recipe variation

Difference in formulation between drinks or cafes.

IN USE allow for recipe variation

Precision check

Strong can mean intense flavor, concentrated coffee, or high caffeine. Ask which feature matters. A customer asking for less foam is not necessarily asking for a weaker flavor or less caffeine.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE COMPARISON

"Are you comparing our small latte and small cappuccino?"

ASK ABOUT PREFERENCE

"Is it the foam you would like less of?"

STATE THE SHARED FEATURE

"Both use the same espresso serving here."

EXPLAIN THE CAPPUCCINO

"Our small cappuccino has more foam."

EXPLAIN THE LATTE

"Our small latte has more liquid milk."

RECOMMEND ON EVIDENCE

"The latte better matches your preference for less foam."

LIMIT THE CLAIM

"I am describing our recipes, not every cafe."

SEPARATE FEATURES

"Foam and caffeine are different questions."

Comparatives

More foam and less foam require a clear comparison item.

Same versus identical

The same espresso serving does not make every drink feature identical.

Here

This word limits a recipe statement to the actual cafe.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY STRONG

"By stronger, do you mean flavor or caffeine?"

KEEP THE SIZE CONSISTENT

"I am comparing the two small sizes."

USE ACCESSIBLE LANGUAGE

"Texture means how it feels in your mouth."

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

"Does the less-foamy option sound closer to what you want?"

AVOID A FALSE MEASUREMENT

"I do not have a measured caffeine figure for these drinks."

CONFIRM NO EXTRA SHOT

"You are not asking for an additional espresso serving."

SEPARATE CREMA

"The espresso surface layer is not the same as milk foam."

CLOSE THE CHOICE

"A small latte, based on your preference for less foam."

Would suit

A recommendation can match a stated preference without claiming universal superiority.

Strong

Clarify whether the speaker means taste, concentration, or caffeine.

Not necessarily

Use it to reject a false implication without inventing an alternative fact.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which recommendation is best supported?

- A** Choose the cappuccino because foam removes caffeine.
- B** Add espresso because less foam means more caffeine.
- C** Every latte everywhere is identical.
- D** Choose the latte if less foam is your priority.

2. Which statement preserves scope?

- A** Small always means one fixed volume.
- B** More milk proves zero caffeine.
- C** In our small recipes, the espresso serving is the same.
- D** All cappuccinos use the same recipe worldwide.

3. What should Sora clarify if asked for stronger?

- A** Whether foam is a medicine
- B** A guaranteed caffeine figure from appearance
- C** Whether Morgan means flavor or caffeine
- D** Only the cup color

4. Which feature is not established?

- A** More liquid milk in the latte
- B** The same espresso serving
- C** Exact caffeine content in milligrams
- D** More foam in the cappuccino

Answers and explanations: page 78.

Less foam, not more caffeine

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

shot count / like-for-like / preference / less foam / extra shot / same espresso serving / recipe variation / texture / stronger / milk proportion

- 01 **Morgan:** I usually order a cappuccino, but sometimes there is more foam than I enjoy. Would the small latte be a better choice here?
- 02 **Sora:** If you want ¹ _____, our small latte is the closer match. The cappuccino has more foam, while the latte has more liquid milk.
- 03 **Morgan:** That sounds promising. I am not trying to order extra coffee, though. Does the latte automatically come with another shot because it has more milk?
- 04 **Sora:** No. In these two small recipes, we use the ² _____. The milk and foam differ, but that does not add another shot.
- 05 **Morgan:** So the difference you are describing is mainly what the milk feels like and how much foam there is on the drink?
- 06 **Sora:** Yes, that is the ³ _____ difference relevant to your choice. Our latte has more liquid milk and less foam than our small cappuccino.
- 07 **Morgan:** I have heard people call cappuccino stronger. Does that mean I would get more caffeine if I chose it instead of the latte?
- 08 **Sora:** People use ⁴ _____ in different ways. They may mean a more noticeable coffee flavor, rather than a larger amount of caffeine in the cup.
- 09 **Morgan:** I see. I do not need a caffeine number; I simply do not want an extra shot added without realizing it.
- 10 **Sora:** Then I will keep the ⁵ _____ at the standard recipe. Neither choice here involves an extra shot unless you separately request one.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Morgan:** That is useful. And when you say more liquid milk, you mean compared with your small cappuccino, not some bigger latte on another menu?
- 12 **Sora:** Exactly. It is a ⁶ _____ comparison between our two small drinks. I am not comparing different cup sizes or promising the same recipe at another cafe.
- 13 **Morgan:** Thanks. I sometimes find menu descriptions assume I know all the coffee terms already. A straightforward comparison makes the choice easier.
- 14 **Sora:** Of course. The ⁷ _____ affects the balance of this drink, but you can simply choose based on how much foam you enjoy.
- 15 **Morgan:** Then I would like the latte. Just to be clear, that is a recommendation about less foam, not a claim that one drink is healthier?
- 16 **Sora:** Correct. I am matching your ⁸ _____ for less foam. I am not making a health recommendation or giving a measured caffeine comparison.
- 17 **Morgan:** Good. I also understand that another cafe might prepare these names a little differently, so I may need to ask there too.
- 18 **Sora:** Yes, ⁹ _____ is possible. Asking about the actual recipe is more reliable than assuming a name fixes every proportion everywhere.
- 19 **Morgan:** All right, a small latte, please. I am happy with the standard espresso serving and the less-foamy option you have described.
- 20 **Sora:** A small latte, understood, with no ¹⁰ _____. I will keep your order to the standard recipe we compared, rather than adding anything you did not ask for.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. less foam | 2. same espresso serving | 3. texture | 4. stronger | 5. shot count | 6. like-for-like | 7. milk proportion | 8. preference | 9. recipe variation | 10. extra shot

Match a different texture preference

F Say it

At another fictional cafe, both small drinks use one espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam; the latte has less. Customer Rei wants more foam, with no added espresso.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cappuccino / extra shot / one / foam

Barista: "The closer match is the ¹ _____."

Customer: "I want more ² _____, not more coffee."

Barista: "Both small recipes use ³ _____ espresso serving."

Customer: "Please do not add an ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. cappuccino | 2. foam | 3. one | 4. extra shot

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Oat does not settle the question

A Read the situation

03

Acknowledge an allergy, preserve the separate modification, and route the actual product and preparation questions for checking.

Customer Priya reports a milk allergy and asks for an oat latte without vanilla syrup. Barista Leo knows oat drink is available but has not checked the current carton ingredients or the shared-equipment arrangements. Shift lead Amina is available to review the request through the cafe allergy procedure. No drink has been prepared or consumed, and no reaction is reported. Leo must communicate what needs checking without claiming that oat, plant-based, or no vanilla automatically establishes suitability.

PEOPLE / Priya: Customer | Leo: Barista

A CLEAR LIMITATION IS RESPECTFUL

A customer may hear yes, we have oat as yes, this is suitable for you. State availability and suitability separately. Acknowledge the allergy directly and explain who will check the actual ingredients and preparation arrangements, without asking the customer to approve an unknown risk.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which allergy is reported?

- A No allergy, only preference
- C Oats established as an allergy

- B Milk
- D Vanilla established as an allergy

2. What has Leo verified so far?

- A Oat drink is available
- C Shared-equipment controls are checked

- B The complete drink is suitable
- D The current carton has no relevant allergens

3. Who can review the request?

- A A completed external laboratory report
- C Amina, the shift lead

- B Nobody identified in the brief
- D An unnamed customer in the queue

Answers and explanations: page 80.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

food allergy

Immune-system reaction to a food that can cause serious harm.

IN USE report a food allergy

milk allergy

Allergy to milk proteins, not simply a preference against milk.

IN USE communicate a milk allergy

allergen

Substance capable of triggering an allergic reaction.

IN USE identify the reported allergen

cross-contact

Unintended introduction of an allergen into food or drink.

IN USE assess cross-contact

ingredient list

Product information identifying its ingredients.

IN USE check the ingredient list

current carton

Actual carton being used now, not an earlier product version.

IN USE check the current carton

product formulation

Ingredients and composition of a particular product.

IN USE verify the product formulation

supplier change

Change in the source or supplied product.

IN USE check after a supplier change

shared equipment

Equipment used for more than one product or ingredient type.

IN USE check shared equipment

preparation arrangement

Actual method and controls used to prepare an order.

IN USE verify preparation arrangements

allergy procedure

Workplace process for receiving and handling allergy requests.

IN USE follow the allergy procedure

shift lead

Person leading the team during the current shift.

IN USE consult the shift lead

Precision check

No vanilla is an omission instruction. Milk allergy is a safety-related disclosure. Keep both in the message; neither replaces the need to check the actual oat product and preparation arrangements.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

suitability

Whether a product and its preparation meet the stated need.

IN USE avoid assuming suitability

availability

Whether an item can currently be supplied.

IN USE confirm availability

oat drink

Beverage made using oats, with other ingredients varying by product.

IN USE check the oat drink

vanilla syrup

Vanilla-flavored liquid ingredient whose formulation must be checked.

IN USE omit vanilla syrup

omission

Instruction to leave out a specified component.

IN USE record the omission

contains statement

Label statement identifying specified allergens in a product.

IN USE review the contains statement

advisory statement

Precautionary label information about possible allergen presence.

IN USE read the advisory statement

milk protein

Protein from milk that may be relevant to milk allergy.

IN USE identify milk proteins

ingredient verification

Checking the relevant information for the actual product.

IN USE complete ingredient verification

allergy flag

Record or signal identifying an allergy-related order.

IN USE preserve the allergy flag

unverified

Not yet established by the required check.

IN USE mark suitability unverified

customer update

Message explaining the current status and next step.

IN USE give a customer update

Precision check

Plant-based and oat name a product category, not a completed assessment of the drink. A familiar brand, an old carton, or the absence of a remembered warning cannot substitute for current relevant information and actual controls.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

ACKNOWLEDGE THE ALLERGY

"Thank you for telling me about your milk allergy."

KEEP THE MODIFICATION

"You also want no vanilla syrup."

STATE AVAILABILITY

"We have oat drink available."

SEPARATE SUITABILITY

"Availability does not confirm suitability for your allergy."

NAME THE FIRST CHECK

"I need to check the current product information."

NAME THE SECOND CHECK

"We also need to check our preparation arrangements."

IDENTIFY SHARED EQUIPMENT

"I have not yet verified the shared-equipment arrangements."

INVOLVE THE LEAD

"I will ask Amina to review this through our allergy procedure."

Available versus suitable

Availability concerns supply; suitability needs the relevant assessment.

Also

Use also to preserve the syrup instruction without replacing the allergy disclosure.

Yet

Not confirmed yet states an unresolved status rather than a final refusal or approval.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

AVOID AN ASSURANCE

"I cannot confirm this drink is suitable yet."

EXPLAIN THE PAUSE

"We need the relevant checks before making a suitability statement."

REJECT A SHORTCUT

"Leaving out syrup does not settle the milk-allergy question."

PROMISE COMMUNICATION

"I will return with the result of the check."

KEEP THE REQUEST TOGETHER

"Oat latte, no vanilla, reported milk allergy."

AVOID AN OLD LABEL

"We need information for the product in use now."

GIVE A STATUS UPDATE

"The request is being checked; there is no confirmed outcome yet."

PRESERVE THE BOUNDARY

"I will not describe an unchecked drink as allergy-safe."

Current

This word identifies the actual product information needed now.

Reported allergy

Report the customer's words accurately without diagnosing or minimizing them.

Check with

Name the person and question, rather than offering an unexplained delay.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response is best?

- A** No vanilla removes every milk risk.
- B** A familiar carton is enough without checking.
- C** We have oat drink, but I need to check the product and preparation for your milk allergy.
- D** Oat always means allergy-safe.

2. What does no vanilla establish?

- A** A verified milk-free preparation system
- B** A confirmed reaction
- C** A complete ingredient assessment
- D** A request to omit that syrup

3. Which summary should reach Amina?

- A** Oat latte already approved
- B** Customer has consumed the wrong drink
- C** Oat latte, no vanilla, reported milk allergy; relevant checks pending
- D** Regular latte, customer dislikes sweet drinks

4. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** No drink has been consumed.
- B** The complete drink is suitable for Priya's allergy.
- C** Oat drink is available.
- D** Amina can review the request.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Oat does not settle the question

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

allergy procedure / shared equipment / ingredient list / availability / allergy flag / omission / shift lead / milk allergy / customer update / suitability

- 01 **Priya:** Could I have an oat latte without vanilla syrup? I also need to tell you that I have a milk allergy.
- 02 **Leo:** Thank you for telling me. I will keep the ¹ _____ clearly attached to the request, as well as the instruction not to add vanilla.
- 03 **Priya:** Do you have oat drink today? I can see it mentioned on the menu, but I know products sometimes change.
- 04 **Leo:** We do have it. That confirms ² _____, but I have not checked the current carton or our preparation arrangements for your allergy.
- 05 **Priya:** All right. I do not want a quick yes based only on the name. What do you need to check first?
- 06 **Leo:** We need the ³ _____ and other relevant information for the carton in use now. I will not rely on what an earlier product contained.
- 07 **Priya:** And the equipment matters too, does it not? I am asking because I can see several different milk products being used behind the counter.
- 08 **Leo:** Yes. We need to check the ⁴ _____ and the actual arrangements for this order. I have not verified those details yet.
- 09 **Priya:** Thank you for being clear. Please keep the no-vanilla part on the order as well; that is still what I would like.
- 10 **Leo:** Certainly. The ⁵ _____ stays on the request. Removing that syrup alone would not answer the milk-allergy question for the rest of the drink.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Priya:** Who can help check it? I would rather wait for a clear answer than have different people making different assumptions.
- 12 **Leo:** Amina is our ⁶ _____. I will ask her to review both the product information and preparation arrangements through our allergy procedure.
- 13 **Priya:** Could you tell her exactly what I asked for? I do not want the allergy to become just a note saying I prefer oat.
- 14 **Leo:** I will say: oat latte, no vanilla syrup, reported milk allergy. The ⁷ _____ must remain distinct from the choice of oat drink.
- 15 **Priya:** That sounds right. You are not saying it has been approved already, just that you are going to check the actual situation?
- 16 **Leo:** Correct. The drink's ⁸ _____ is not confirmed yet. I do not want my explanation of the next step to sound like a guarantee.
- 17 **Priya:** Understood. Nothing has been made for me yet, so please come back with the result before we go any further.
- 18 **Leo:** I will give you a ⁹ _____ after the review. If something remains unknown, I will say that clearly instead of filling in the gap.
- 19 **Priya:** Thank you. I appreciate knowing what is happening, especially when the menu name by itself does not answer the question.
- 20 **Leo:** You are welcome. I will now take the full request to Amina under our ¹⁰ _____, keeping the allergy and the separate no-vanilla instruction together.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. milk allergy | 2. availability | 3. ingredient list | 4. shared equipment | 5. omission | 6. shift lead | 7. allergy flag | 8. suitability | 9. customer update | 10. allergy procedure

Keep a new allergy request intact

F Say it

03

Customer Noor requests a soy latte without caramel and reports a sesame allergy. Lead Rosa is available. Product and preparation checks are incomplete.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / Rosa / sesame / caramel

Barista: "The reported allergy is ¹ _____."

Customer: "Please leave out ² _____."

Barista: "The lead available to review this is ³ _____."

Barista: "Suitability remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. sesame | 2. caramel | 3. Rosa | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two customers named Sam

A Read the situation

Interrupt a mistaken pickup politely, match the ticket and drink, and explain readiness without inventing a wait.

Two customers at the cafe are named Sam. Ticket 64 is a small hot latte and is complete. Ticket 67 is a large iced decaf latte and is still in progress. The Sam holding ticket 67 hears the name called and reaches toward the completed cup. Barista Hana notices before the cup is collected. No one has consumed the drink. Hana needs to clarify the ticket number and drink details, preserve the completed drink for the correct customer, and explain that ticket 67 is not ready. No reliable wait estimate is supplied.

PEOPLE / Sam: Customer holding ticket 67 | Hana: Pickup barista

CORRECT THE MATCH WITHOUT BLAMING THE PERSON

A shared name makes a mix-up understandable. Use a brief interruption, then give the identifying detail that resolves it. Do not call the customer careless. A number plus drink description is clearer than repeating the same name more loudly.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which ticket belongs to this Sam?

- A Both tickets automatically
- C 67

- B No ticket is known
- D 64

2. Which drink is complete?

- A Both drinks
- C Ticket 64, small hot latte

- B Neither drink
- D Ticket 67, large iced decaf latte

3. What wait can Hana promise?

- A The time printed on another receipt
- C Exactly one minute

- B No precise wait is established
- D Immediate collection of 67

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

pickup counter

Area where prepared orders are collected.

IN USE wait at the pickup counter

ticket number

Number used to identify an order.

IN USE confirm the ticket number

order name

Customer name attached to an order.

IN USE call the order name

duplicate name

Name shared by more than one current customer.

IN USE resolve a duplicate name

completed drink

Drink whose preparation is finished.

IN USE identify the completed drink

in progress

Started or underway but not yet finished.

IN USE mark the order in progress

ready call

Announcement that a specified item can be collected.

IN USE make a clear ready call

drink description

Identifying details such as size, temperature, and coffee choice.

IN USE repeat the drink description

cup label

Information attached to a cup to identify its order.

IN USE read the cup label

collection

Taking possession of the prepared order.

IN USE confirm before collection

order match

Agreement between the customer order and prepared item.

IN USE verify the order match

queue

Line or sequence of customers or pending orders.

IN USE manage the queue

Precision check

A ready call applies to the identified drink, not everyone with the same name. Add the ticket number and key drink details. Keep ready for ticket 64 separate from in progress for ticket 67.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

queue position

Place in a waiting or production sequence.

IN USE explain queue position

preparation status

Current stage of making an item.

IN USE check preparation status

partial order

Order with some but not all items complete.

IN USE identify a partial order

estimated wait

Approximate expected remaining delay.

IN USE check the estimated wait

time promise

Commitment about when an item will be ready.

IN USE avoid an unsupported time promise

pickup mix-up

Confusion about which customer should collect an item.

IN USE prevent a pickup mix-up

identifier

Detail used to distinguish one order from another.

IN USE use a second identifier

readiness

State of being ready for the relevant next step.

IN USE confirm readiness

handover point

Place or stage where an item passes to the customer.

IN USE check at the handover point

collection check

Verification that the correct order is being collected.

IN USE complete the collection check

pending item

Item that has not yet reached the required finished state.

IN USE identify the pending item

polite interruption

Brief respectful intervention to prevent a misunderstanding.

IN USE use a polite interruption

Precision check

Order sequence does not always give a reliable completion time. Different drinks can take different paths through the bar. Explain the verified status and check an estimate instead of converting a queue position into a promise.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

INTERRUPT BRIEFLY

"One moment, please; let me check the ticket."

IDENTIFY THE COMPLETED CUP

"This is ticket 64, the small hot latte."

CONFIRM THE OTHER ORDER

"Yours is ticket 67, the large iced decaf latte."

AVOID A FALSE WAIT

"I do not have a checked wait estimate yet."

ASK FOR THE IDENTIFIER

"What number is on your receipt?"

NAME THE SHARED-NAME ISSUE

"We have two orders under Sam."

STATE THE STATUS

"That drink is still in progress."

USE BOTH IDENTIFIERS

"I will call the number and drink as well as the name."

One moment

A concise interruption can prevent a wrong handover without sounding accusatory.

This versus yours

Name the ticket after each pronoun when two orders are close together.

Still

Still in progress preserves the current unfinished state.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PREVENT COLLECTION

"Please wait while I match this cup to the order."

KEEP THE CORRECT CUP

"This completed drink belongs to the other ticket."

EXPLAIN THE NEXT UPDATE

"I can check with the bar for an estimate."

REPEAT KEY MODIFIERS

"Large, iced, and decaf are all on ticket 67."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONFUSION

"I understand why you thought that call was yours."

CHECK BEFORE ANNOUNCING

"I will confirm readiness before calling it."

SEPARATE THE ORDERS

"One is complete; the other is still being made."

CLOSE THE CORRECTION

"Thank you; we have matched the right order now."

Ready for whom

A readiness statement needs the correct order identifier.

Yet

No estimate yet does not mean immediate service or an unlimited delay.

Number clarity

Repeat sixty-seven distinctly from sixty-four rather than saying the last digit alone.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which call is least ambiguous?

- A** Sam!
- B** Your regular is here
- C** The first one is ready for everyone
- D** Sam, ticket 64, small hot latte

2. Which status report is correct?

- A** Ticket 64 is complete; ticket 67 is in progress.
- B** Both are complete because Sam was called.
- C** Ticket 67 is complete because the cup is visible.
- D** Neither ticket exists until collection.

3. Which response invents a fact?

- A** Your number is 67.
- B** This cup is ticket 64.
- C** We have two customers named Sam.
- D** Yours will definitely be ready in thirty seconds.

4. Why check before collection?

- A** Decaf means every drink is interchangeable.
- B** A receipt number changes the recipe automatically.
- C** The name alone does not distinguish the orders.
- D** Large and small mean the same thing.

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Two customers named Sam

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pickup mix-up / cup label / handover point / in progress / ready call / estimated wait / drink description / completed drink / ticket number / sixty-four

- 01 **Sam:** I heard Sam called. Is this my latte? I have been waiting near the counter, and I thought that must be mine.
- 02 **Hana:** One moment, please. Could I check your ¹ _____ before you take it? We have two customers named Sam waiting for different drinks.
- 03 **Sam:** Of course. My receipt says sixty-seven. I ordered the large iced decaf latte, so perhaps this is the other person's cup.
- 04 **Hana:** Thank you. This completed cup is ² _____, a small hot latte. Yours is sixty-seven, so I want to keep the two orders separate.
- 05 **Sam:** I can see the cup is smaller now. I just reacted to the name without looking closely at the label.
- 06 **Hana:** That is understandable. Your ³ _____ is large iced decaf latte. Those details do not match the small hot drink that was called.
- 07 **Sam:** Is mine finished somewhere else on the counter, then? I do not want to stand in the wrong place or miss another call.
- 08 **Hana:** Your drink is still ⁴ _____. I have checked the current status, and it has not reached the pickup stage yet.
- 09 **Sam:** All right. Do you know how long it will be? I am not asking you to rush it, just checking before I step aside.
- 10 **Hana:** I do not have an ⁵ _____ to give you yet. I can check with the bar, but I do not want to invent a time.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Sam:** That is fair. When you call it, could you say the number too? Otherwise we might both come forward again.
- 12 **Hana:** Certainly. I will include the number and drink in the ⁶ _____, not just Sam. That will make the collection clearer for both of you.
- 13 **Sam:** Thanks. I have not picked this one up, so I will leave it here for the person with sixty-four.
- 14 **Hana:** Thank you. The ⁷ _____ belongs to that ticket. I will keep it matched to its order rather than treating the shared name as enough.
- 15 **Sam:** And mine is definitely still marked decaf? That is one of the details I particularly wanted to make sure had not been lost.
- 16 **Hana:** Yes. The ⁸ _____ for your order retains large, iced, and decaf. We are clarifying collection, not changing those choices.
- 17 **Sam:** Good. I will stay nearby and listen for sixty-seven with the full drink description. That should be much easier to recognize.
- 18 **Hana:** Exactly. At the ⁹ _____, we can match the number and drink before collection. That avoids relying on a name that two people share.
- 19 **Sam:** Thank you for catching it. I would have been surprised to walk away with a small hot drink after ordering something quite different.
- 20 **Hana:** You are welcome. We have resolved the ¹⁰ _____, and yours remains in progress. I will make the next call clear once that drink is actually ready.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. ticket number | 2. sixty-four | 3. drink description | 4. in progress | 5. estimated wait | 6. ready call | 7. completed drink | 8. cup label | 9. handover point | 10. pickup mix-up

Separate two orders under Lee

F Say it

Ticket 81 is a completed small tea. Ticket 84 is a large iced coffee still in progress. Both orders use Lee. The customer in front of you holds ticket 84.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

84 / 81 / in progress / coffee

Barista: "Your ticket number is ¹ _____."

Customer: "I ordered the large iced ² _____."

Barista: "The completed small tea belongs to ticket ³ _____."

Barista: "Your order remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. 84 | 2. coffee | 3. 81 | 4. in progress

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The label is not the ticket

A Read the situation

Identify an order-label mismatch, request a checked remake, and keep timing and payment decisions separate.

05

Ticket 22 requests a small iced latte with no syrup. Its cup label says hot vanilla latte. The customer has not collected the drink. Counter worker Ben catches the mismatch and asks barista Imani to arrange a replacement matching the ticket. A remake is available, but the current wait has not been checked. No refund, complimentary extra, or queue priority has been authorized. The conversation concerns correcting and verifying the order, not guessing how the mismatch happened or merely relabeling an unchecked drink.

PEOPLE / Ben: Counter worker | Imani: Barista

OWN THE CORRECTION WITHOUT ASSIGNING A CULPRIT

Point to the two records and name their difference. A neutral description makes it easier to correct the order quickly. Keep an apology or acknowledgement separate from an unsupported accusation, a promised refund, or a made-up completion time.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does ticket 22 request?

A Hot vanilla latte

C A refund already approved

B Large cappuccino with syrup

D Small iced latte with no syrup

2. What is wrong with the cup label?

A It says the customer has collected it

C It says hot vanilla latte

B It authorizes a free extra

D It confirms the ticket exactly

3. Which outcome is not established?

A The existence of a mismatch

C A checked remake wait

B That collection has not occurred

D The customer's order details

Answers and explanations: page 84.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

remake

New preparation intended to replace an incorrect or unsatisfactory item.

IN USE request a remake

replacement

Item supplied instead of another item.

IN USE arrange a replacement

mismatch

Difference between records or items that should agree.

IN USE identify a mismatch

source ticket

Original order record used to verify the intended drink.

IN USE check the source ticket

incorrect label

Cup information that does not match the intended order.

IN USE correct an incorrect label

order specification

Complete stated details of the requested item.

IN USE preserve the order specification

temperature modifier

Order detail identifying hot or iced preparation.

IN USE check the temperature modifier

syrup omission

Instruction not to include a named or any syrup.

IN USE preserve the syrup omission

verification

Check that an item or record meets the relevant requirement.

IN USE complete verification

relabeling

Changing the information attached to an item.

IN USE distinguish relabeling from remaking

production error

Mistake during preparation or production.

IN USE investigate a production error

entry error

Mistake when recording information.

IN USE investigate an entry error

Precision check

A label can be wrong even when the intended order is clear. Compare it with the source ticket. Changing the label alone does not verify what is in the cup or complete the requested remake.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cause

Reason an event occurred, requiring evidence.

IN USE avoid guessing the cause

correction request

Message identifying what must be changed.

IN USE send a correction request

service recovery

Response intended to address a service failure.

IN USE coordinate service recovery

acknowledgement

Clear recognition of a reported issue.

IN USE give an acknowledgement

apology

Expression of regret for an error or inconvenience.

IN USE offer an apology

refund

Return of money under an applicable decision or policy.

IN USE request a refund review

complimentary item

Item supplied without charge under an authorized arrangement.

IN USE authorize a complimentary item

queue priority

Order's position or precedence in preparation.

IN USE confirm queue priority

remake status

Current stage of preparing the replacement.

IN USE update remake status

checked estimate

Time estimate obtained from the relevant current source.

IN USE give a checked estimate

customer-facing message

Explanation intended for the customer rather than internal shorthand.

IN USE prepare a customer-facing message

final match

Verification that the finished replacement agrees with the intended order.

IN USE confirm the final match

Precision check

A remake, a refund, and a complimentary item are different actions. Confirm only the action actually available or authorized. Keep an unchecked wait distinct from a checked estimate and from a guaranteed completion time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE ORDER

"I need a correction for ticket 22."

STATE THE MISMATCH

"The cup label says hot vanilla latte."

CONFIRM COLLECTION STATUS

"The customer has not collected it."

AVOID A LABEL-ONLY FIX

"Please verify the drink, not just the printed wording."

STATE THE TICKET

"The ticket says small iced latte, no syrup."

PROTECT THE MODIFIERS

"Iced and no syrup both need to stay on the replacement."

REQUEST THE REMAKE

"Can you arrange a remake matching the ticket?"

ACKNOWLEDGE THE ISSUE

"I see the mismatch."

Says versus contains

A label says something; it does not by itself prove the drink contents.

Matching

A replacement must match all specified modifiers, not only the drink name.

Has not collected

This describes the actual stage without inventing consumption or harm.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"We have not established how it happened."

AVOID A FALSE PROMISE

"I have not checked the wait yet."

AVOID AN EXTRA OFFER

"I have not been authorized to add a complimentary item."

VERIFY BEFORE PICKUP

"Match the replacement to the ticket before collection."

CHECK TIMING

"What is the current remake estimate?"

SEPARATE PAYMENT

"No refund decision has been made."

UPDATE THE CUSTOMER

"We are correcting the order and checking the wait."

CLOSE THE LOOP

"Please tell me when the checked replacement is ready."

Available versus complete

An available remake is not an already prepared replacement.

Yet

The wait is unchecked yet; that is not a promise of immediate service.

Separate decisions

Correction, compensation, and timing need their own factual basis.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which request preserves the order?

- A** Change only the label to iced.
- B** Keep vanilla because the cup says so.
- C** Upgrade it without asking.
- D** Remake ticket 22 as a small iced latte with no syrup.

2. Which statement should Ben avoid?

- A** Your replacement will definitely be ready in one minute.
- B** We are correcting the mismatch.
- C** The wait has not been checked yet.
- D** The ticket requests no syrup.

3. What does a corrected label alone establish?

- A** Corrected wording, not verified drink contents
- B** A completed remake automatically
- C** A refund approval
- D** That no production error is possible

4. Which report avoids blame?

- A** The ticket and cup label do not match.
- B** Imani deliberately ignored the customer.
- C** The customer must have ordered wrongly.
- D** The machine is definitely defective.

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The label is not the ticket

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

final match / remake status / mismatch / order specification / remake / source ticket / cause / checked estimate / refund / customer-facing message

- 01 **Ben:** I need a correction for ticket twenty-two before it reaches the customer. The cup label does not match the order on the ticket.
- 02 **Imani:** Let us compare the ¹ _____ with the label. Please give me the full drink details, including the size and any modifications.
- 03 **Ben:** The ticket says small iced latte with no syrup. The cup is labeled hot vanilla latte, so there are two clear differences.
- 04 **Imani:** I see the ² _____. Both the temperature description and the syrup instruction conflict with the order we need to fulfill.
- 05 **Ben:** The customer has not collected it. I caught it while checking the cup against the ticket, before calling the order at pickup.
- 06 **Imani:** Thank you. We can arrange a ³ _____ matching the ticket. I will not treat changing the words on the label as proof the drink is correct.
- 07 **Ben:** Good. Please keep it small and iced, with no syrup. I do not want one detail corrected while the other gets lost.
- 08 **Imani:** I will preserve the complete ⁴ _____. Small iced latte, no syrup, ticket twenty-two. That is the instruction for the replacement.
- 09 **Ben:** Do you know the current wait? I need to tell the customer what is happening, but I have not given them a time.
- 10 **Imani:** I have not obtained a ⁵ _____ yet. A replacement is available, but I cannot turn that into an immediate completion promise.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Ben:** Then I will explain that we caught a label mismatch and are correcting the order. I can say the wait is being checked.
- 12 **Imani:** That is an accurate ⁶ _____. It tells them the next step without claiming the drink is ready or the delay will be a particular length.
- 13 **Ben:** Should I offer a refund or an extra drink? I would rather check before making an offer that someone else has to reverse.
- 14 **Imani:** No ⁷ _____ has been authorized in this exchange. Keep any payment or complimentary-item request within the actual service-recovery process.
- 15 **Ben:** Understood. I will not turn a correction into a compensation promise. I will also avoid saying who caused it, since we do not know.
- 16 **Imani:** Exactly. We have identified the difference, not the ⁸ _____. We can investigate separately without making the customer wait through an argument about blame.
- 17 **Ben:** When the replacement is prepared, please check it against the ticket and let me know. I will use the ticket number at pickup.
- 18 **Imani:** Yes, the ⁹ _____ matters before collection. We need the right drink and the right identifying information, not simply a newly printed label.
- 19 **Ben:** Thank you. For now I will say the correction is underway and the wait is still being checked, without claiming more than that.
- 20 **Imani:** I will update you on ¹⁰ _____ as it changes. Until the replacement is prepared and checked, we should not describe ticket twenty-two as ready.

05

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. source ticket | 2. mismatch | 3. remake | 4. order specification | 5. checked estimate | 6. customer-facing message | 7. refund | 8. cause | 9. final match | 10. remake status

Correct another label mismatch

F Say it

Ticket 35 requests a large hot latte with oat drink and no syrup. The label says iced with dairy milk. A remake is available; the wait remains unchecked.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

no syrup / oat drink / unchecked / hot

Counter: "The intended temperature is ¹ _____."

Barista: "The specified milk alternative is ² _____."

Counter: "The ticket also requests ³ _____."

Barista: "The current wait is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. hot | 2. oat drink | 3. no syrup | 4. unchecked

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Before the beans are ground

A Read the situation

Clarify the intended brewer, explain sensory wording, and avoid an irreversible choice based on an ambiguous request.

Customer Jamie is buying a gift bag and asks for normal ground coffee. Jamie does not know the recipient brewer or whether the recipient owns a grinder. This cafe sells the same coffee whole or ground, but grinding cannot be undone. The bag describes a hazelnut flavor note; that wording describes a sensory impression, not an ingredient declaration. Barista Rafael needs to explain the distinction, ask for useful brewing information, and avoid guessing a grind setting or declaring allergen suitability from the tasting note. No purchase choice has yet been finalized.

PEOPLE / Jamie: Gift customer | Rafael: Barista

06

MAKE EXPERTISE USABLE

Customers buying gifts may not know equipment names. Explain why the brewer matters before listing specialist terms. Offer a clear next step, such as obtaining the brewer name, while leaving the purchase choice with the customer rather than pretending one grind fits every method.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What information is missing?

- A Whether coffee is sold at all
- C The existence of a flavor note

- B Whether grinding can be undone
- D The recipient's brewer and grinder availability

2. What does hazelnut mean on this bag?

- A Proof the coffee is suitable for every nut allergy
- C A flavor note, not an ingredient declaration

- B A specified grind setting
- D Proof of added hazelnuts

3. What should happen before choosing a grind?

- A Clarify the intended brewing method
- C Grind first and restore whole beans later

- B Select normal as a universal setting
- D Infer the brewer from the gift recipient's name

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

whole bean

Coffee sold as intact roasted beans rather than ground particles.

IN USE choose whole bean

ground coffee

Roasted coffee reduced to particles for brewing.

IN USE buy ground coffee

grind size

Size of the coffee particles after grinding.

IN USE match the grind size

grind setting

Grinder adjustment used to produce a target particle size.

IN USE confirm the grind setting

brewer

Device or equipment used to make coffee.

IN USE identify the brewer

brewing method

Process used to extract coffee into water.

IN USE clarify the brewing method

drip brewer

Device that passes water through coffee held in a filter.

IN USE use a drip brewer

pour-over

Brewing method in which water is poured over coffee in a filter.

IN USE prepare a pour-over

French press

Immersion brewer with a plunger and filter.

IN USE identify a French press

espresso machine

Device that brews espresso using pressurized water.

IN USE identify an espresso machine

cold brew

Coffee extracted using cool or cold water over an extended period.

IN USE distinguish cold brew

burr grinder

Grinder that reduces beans between two abrasive grinding surfaces.

IN USE use a burr grinder

06

Precision check

A hazelnut tasting note does not establish added hazelnut, and it does not certify absence of allergens. Ingredient and handling questions require relevant product information, not an interpretation of flavor language.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

blade grinder

Grinder that chops beans using rotating blades.

IN USE identify a blade grinder

coarse grind

Relatively large coffee particles.

IN USE request a coarse grind

fine grind

Relatively small coffee particles.

IN USE request a fine grind

particle size

Dimension of individual ground-coffee pieces.

IN USE compare particle size

roast level

Degree to which coffee has been roasted.

IN USE describe the roast level

origin

Geographic source identified for a coffee.

IN USE check the coffee origin

blend

Coffee combining more than one component lot or source.

IN USE describe a blend

single origin

Coffee presented as from one defined source, whose scope should be checked.

IN USE clarify single origin

tasting note

Word describing a sensory impression of flavor or aroma.

IN USE explain a tasting note

aroma

Smell perceived from coffee.

IN USE describe the aroma

ingredient declaration

Information stating what ingredients a product contains.

IN USE check the ingredient declaration

gift recipient

Person who will receive the purchased gift.

IN USE ask about the gift recipient

Precision check

Normal ground is not a universal technical setting. Ask about the brewer before grinding. Whole beans avoid an immediate grind choice, but they are not automatically convenient if the recipient has no suitable grinder.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK ABOUT USE

"How will the recipient brew the coffee?"

CLARIFY NORMAL

"Which brewing method do you mean by normal ground?"

06

EXPLAIN THE REASON

"The useful grind depends on the brewer."

ASK FOR EQUIPMENT

"Do you know the brewer name or type?"

OFFER RECOGNIZABLE EXAMPLES

"Is it a drip brewer, French press, or espresso machine?"

AVOID GUESSING

"I do not want to choose a grind from that word alone."

EXPLAIN THE IRREVERSIBLE STEP

"Once we grind these beans, we cannot turn them back into whole beans."

KEEP THE OPTIONS CLEAR

"We sell this coffee whole or ground."

Ground versus grind

Ground is the product form; grind can name the particle size or the action.

For

Ground for a French press identifies intended use, not coffee origin.

Note

A tasting note describes perception rather than a list of added ingredients.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK ABOUT A GRINDER

"Does the recipient have a grinder?"

SEPARATE INGREDIENTS

"That is not an ingredient declaration."

DESCRIBE SENSORY LANGUAGE

"It names a flavor impression someone may perceive."

OFFER A NEXT STEP

"You could check the brewer details before we grind the bag."

CLARIFY THE LABEL

"Hazelnut here is a tasting note."

AVOID AN ALLERGY CLAIM

"The flavor note does not establish allergen suitability."

LEAVE THE CHOICE OPEN

"We have not finalized the grind choice yet."

CONFIRM BEFORE ACTION

"I will wait for a clear choice before grinding."

06

Could

A suggested next step leaves the decision with the customer.

Cannot undo

State the practical consequence before the irreversible preparation step.

Not established

Unknown equipment should remain unknown rather than becoming an assumed default.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response to normal ground is strongest?

- A** What brewer will the recipient use?
- B** Every brewer takes exactly the same grind.
- C** Normal must mean espresso.
- D** I will grind it before we ask.

2. What can Rafael infer from hazelnut alone?

- A** The recipient owns a grinder
- B** A stated sensory description, not ingredient or allergy status
- C** Guaranteed added hazelnuts
- D** Guaranteed absence of all allergens

3. Why not automatically recommend whole beans?

- A** Whole beans cannot be sold.
- B** Whole beans always contain syrup.
- C** Grinding is fully reversible.
- D** The recipient may not have a suitable grinder.

4. Which statement preserves the decision stage?

- A** The customer selected fine grind.
- B** The bag is already ground correctly.
- C** The grind choice has not been finalized.
- D** A French-press grind has been approved.

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

Before the beans are ground

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

brewing method / grind setting / grind size / brewer type / whole bean / brewer / ingredient
declaration / tasting note / purchase choice / allergen suitability

06

- 01 **Jamie:** I am buying a bag for a friend. Could you make it normal ground, please? I do not usually buy coffee for someone else.
- 02 **Rafael:** Certainly, but first, do you know their ¹ _____? The useful grind depends on how they make coffee, rather than one setting that works for every brewer.
- 03 **Jamie:** I am not sure. I have seen a coffee machine in their kitchen, but I could not tell you what type it is.
- 04 **Rafael:** That is fine. The ² _____ might be a drip machine or an espresso machine, for example, and those are not the same grinding request.
- 05 **Jamie:** I had not realized that. Can you just grind it now and make it coarser later if my friend tells me it is wrong?
- 06 **Rafael:** We cannot restore larger particles once they have been reduced. I would confirm the ³ _____ before doing that, rather than promise that a wrong setting can be undone.
- 07 **Jamie:** All right. You sell the same coffee as whole beans too, do you not? Maybe that would avoid deciding immediately.
- 08 **Rafael:** We do offer ⁴ _____. That leaves grinding until later, but it helps to know whether your friend has a suitable grinder.
- 09 **Jamie:** I do not know that either. I can ask someone who lives with them without spoiling the gift, so perhaps I should check.
- 10 **Rafael:** That sounds useful. We have not finalized the ⁵ _____, and I have not ground the bag. There is time to get the relevant information first.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Jamie:** One other question: the bag says hazelnut. Does that mean someone added hazelnuts to the coffee, like a flavored syrup?
- 12 **Rafael:** On this bag, hazelnut is a ⁶ _____. It describes a flavor impression associated with the coffee, not a statement that hazelnuts were added.
- 13 **Jamie:** So it is describing how the coffee may taste. It is not the same kind of information as the ingredients on food packaging?
- 14 **Rafael:** Correct. A tasting note is not an ⁷ _____. If someone has an ingredient or allergy question, we need the relevant product information instead.
- 15 **Jamie:** Could somebody read that note as proof that there are no nut ingredients, since it is only describing flavor? I would not want to misunderstand.
- 16 **Rafael:** No. It does not establish ⁸ _____ either way. We should not turn the distinction into an assurance about an ingredient or preparation question we have not checked.
- 17 **Jamie:** That makes sense. For this gift, I will first find out the brewing equipment and whether my friend already owns a grinder.
- 18 **Rafael:** Once you know the ⁹ _____, we can discuss the grind request much more clearly. You can bring the name or a clear description of the equipment.
- 19 **Jamie:** Thank you. Please leave the bag unground while I check. I have not decided to buy it as whole beans permanently; I am just pausing.
- 20 **Rafael:** Understood. The ¹⁰ _____ is still open, and no grinding will happen from this conversation alone. We will confirm your actual choice before proceeding.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. brewing method | 2. brewer | 3. grind size | 4. whole bean | 5. grind setting | 6. tasting note | 7. ingredient declaration | 8. allergen suitability | 9. brewer type | 10. purchase choice

Clarify a different gift-coffee request

F Say it

Customer Mina confirms the recipient uses a French press and wants the bag ground for it. The bag lists cocoa as a flavor note. No allergy assessment has been made.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

flavor note / French press / assessment / brewer

Customer: "The recipient uses a ¹ _____."

Barista: "We should match the grind to that ² _____."

Customer: "Cocoa here is a ³ _____."

Barista: "That wording is not an allergy ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. French press | 2. brewer | 3. flavor note | 4. assessment

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The combo and the upcharge

A Read the situation

Explain the complete comparison, retain an applicable upcharge, and offer a confirmed available item without pressure.

This fictional cafe lists a latte at \$4, an oat-drink upcharge at \$0.50, and a pastry at \$3. Its \$6 combo includes a standard latte and one eligible pastry; the oat upcharge still applies. For this transaction these figures include all compulsory charges. Customer Casey wants an oat latte and pastry. The requested almond pastry is sold out, but an eligible plain pastry is available at the same listed pastry price. Casey has not accepted that substitution or paid. Barista Dana must explain \$6.50 as the oat combo, compared with \$7.50 separately, without charging before the choice is confirmed.

PEOPLE / Casey: Customer | Dana: Counter barista

07

AN OFFER NEEDS A GENUINE CHOICE

A confident price explanation names what is included and what costs extra. When an item is sold out, state that directly and offer a real available alternative. Avoid making a substitution sound compulsory just because it fits a promotion.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the oat combo price?

A \$6.00

B \$7.50

C \$4.50

D \$6.50

2. What would the same selected items cost separately?

A \$7.00 with no upcharge

B \$3.50

C \$7.50

D \$6.50

3. Which pastry is available?

A The eligible plain pastry

B The requested almond pastry

C Every pastry on the menu

D No pastry at all

Answers and explanations: page 88.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

combo

Group of items sold together under a specified offer.

IN USE explain the combo

upcharge

Extra amount added for a selected variation.

IN USE apply the oat upcharge

base price

Price before specified optional additions.

IN USE state the base price

standalone price

Price for an item purchased separately.

IN USE compare the standalone price

eligible item

Item that qualifies for a particular offer.

IN USE confirm an eligible item

included item

Item covered by the stated offer price.

IN USE name the included items

optional addition

Extra item or variation selected by the customer.

IN USE confirm an optional addition

price breakdown

Explanation of the components making up a price.

IN USE give a price breakdown

combined price

Price for the selected items together.

IN USE state the combined price

separate purchase

Purchase of items at their individual prices.

IN USE compare a separate purchase

price difference

Amount by which two prices differ.

IN USE calculate the price difference

saving

Reduction compared with a stated comparison price.

IN USE explain the saving

Precision check

The oat upcharge applies in both comparisons. Combo: $\$6 + \$0.50 = \$6.50$. Separate: $\$4 + \$0.50 + \$3 = \7.50 . The saving is \$1 for the same selected items.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

sold out

No stock currently available for sale.

IN USE mark the pastry sold out

available alternative

Different item that can currently be supplied.

IN USE offer an available alternative

substitution

Replacement of a requested item with another.

IN USE confirm a substitution

customer acceptance

Customer's explicit agreement to an offered choice.

IN USE obtain customer acceptance

promotion terms

Conditions governing a special offer.

IN USE check the promotion terms

compulsory charge

Amount required rather than optionally selected.

IN USE include compulsory charges

displayed price

Price shown to customers.

IN USE verify the displayed price

checkout total

Amount due for the confirmed transaction.

IN USE confirm the checkout total

point of sale

System or place where the sale is recorded and paid.

IN USE check the point of sale

payment authorization

Approval for a payment transaction.

IN USE obtain payment authorization

itemized receipt

Receipt showing individual items or charges.

IN USE provide an itemized receipt

stock status

Whether and how an item is available.

IN USE update the stock status

07

Precision check

An available pastry is not an accepted substitution. Confirm the actual item and price before payment. These figures include compulsory charges only because this fictional transaction explicitly says so; real menus and tax arrangements vary.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

EXPLAIN THE SHORTAGE

"The almond pastry is sold out."

KEEP ACCEPTANCE OPEN

"Would you like that instead?"

RETAIN THE UPCHARGE

"Oat drink adds fifty cents, including with the combo."

GIVE THE SEPARATE PRICE

"Bought separately, those items are seven dollars fifty."

OFFER THE AVAILABLE ITEM

"We have the plain pastry available."

STATE THE BASE OFFER

"The standard latte-and-pastry combo is six dollars."

GIVE THE COMBINED PRICE

"That makes the oat combo six dollars fifty."

EXPLAIN THE SAVING

"The combo is one dollar less for those same items."

07

Including with

This phrase makes clear that the surcharge survives the promotion.

Instead

Use instead only for an offered or accepted replacement, not a silent change.

Same items

A fair saving comparison keeps the selected items unchanged.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

NAME THE ELIGIBLE PASTRY

"The plain pastry qualifies for this offer."

CLARIFY INCLUDED CHARGES

"These stated prices include the compulsory charges here."

PAUSE PAYMENT

"I will confirm the choice before taking payment."

CORRECT A MISUNDERSTANDING

"The combo does not remove the oat upcharge."

AVOID A FORCED SUBSTITUTE

"You do not have to choose the alternative."

CHECK THE CHOICE

"Shall I enter the oat combo with the plain pastry?"

READ THE BREAKDOWN

"Six dollars for the combo, plus fifty cents for oat."

KEEP THE RECORD CLEAR

"The receipt should match the items you actually select."

07

Six fifty

Common spoken form for \$6.50; repeat dollars and cents if unclear.

Sold out

This describes current stock, not permanent removal from the menu.

Before payment

Confirm item choice and applicable charges before processing the transaction.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which calculation is correct?

- A** $\$6 + \$3 = \$9.00$ for the combo
- B** $\$6 + \$0.50 = \$6.50$
- C** $\$6 - \$0.50 = \$5.50$
- D** $\$4 + \$3 = \$6.50$

2. How much less is the combo than separate purchase?

- A** \$0.50
- B** \$1.50
- C** \$3.00
- D** \$1.00

3. Which statement wrongly treats an offer as acceptance?

- A** The plain pastry is available.
- B** Would you like the plain pastry instead?
- C** The plain pastry qualifies for the combo.
- D** I have charged you for the plain pastry because almond is sold out.

4. Why mention charge inclusion?

- A** To claim every jurisdiction uses identical taxes
- B** To guarantee all future prices
- C** To make an unselected extra compulsory
- D** To keep this transaction's stated comparison complete

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The combo and the upcharge

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

alternative / combo / price breakdown / compulsory charges / selection / eligible item / saving / upcharge / sold out / separate price

07

- 01 **Casey:** Could I have an oat latte and an almond pastry? I saw a combo on the board, but I am not sure how the oat charge works.
- 02 **Dana:** I can explain it. First, the almond pastry is ¹ _____. We have a plain pastry available that qualifies for the combo, if you would like that instead.
- 03 **Casey:** Possibly. Please tell me the price before I decide, because I would like to compare the offer with buying the items separately.
- 04 **Dana:** The standard latte-and-pastry ² _____ is six dollars. Oat drink adds fifty cents, and that addition still applies when you choose the combo.
- 05 **Casey:** So the offer does not mean the oat drink is automatically included at no extra charge? I want to make sure I heard that correctly.
- 06 **Dana:** Correct. The oat ³ _____ is fifty cents in either comparison. With it, the combo price is six dollars fifty.
- 07 **Casey:** And if I bought the latte with oat and the plain pastry as separate items, what would those same choices come to?
- 08 **Dana:** The ⁴ _____ is seven dollars fifty: four dollars for the latte, fifty cents for oat drink, and three dollars for the pastry.
- 09 **Casey:** That makes the combo a dollar less, then. I was getting confused because I kept comparing a standard latte with the oat version.
- 10 **Dana:** Yes, the ⁵ _____ is one dollar for those same choices. Comparing the same milk option in both totals keeps the difference clear.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Casey:** Does the plain pastry definitely qualify, or does the offer only apply to the almond one that is no longer available?
- 12 **Dana:** The plain pastry is an ⁶ _____. It has the same three-dollar separate price and can be the pastry in this combo.
- 13 **Casey:** Thank you. Are those the complete prices for this transaction, or will another required charge appear when you ring it up?
- 14 **Dana:** These figures include the ⁷ _____ here. The oat combo is six dollars fifty; the same items separately are seven dollars fifty.
- 15 **Casey:** All right. I am still deciding whether I want the plain pastry. Please do not replace the almond one automatically just because it is available.
- 16 **Dana:** Of course. An available ⁸ _____ is your choice, not an instruction for me to charge you. I will wait for you to confirm the actual items.
- 17 **Casey:** I appreciate that. Could you repeat the combo breakdown once more, without the separate prices, so I can hear the two parts clearly?
- 18 **Dana:** The ⁹ _____ is six dollars for the combo plus fifty cents for oat drink. That is six dollars fifty with the plain pastry.
- 19 **Casey:** I understand now. Please give me a moment to decide about the pastry. I have not chosen a different item yet.
- 20 **Dana:** Certainly. We will confirm your ¹⁰ _____ before payment. I have explained the options, but I will not enter a substitution as though you had already agreed.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. sold out | 2. combo | 3. upcharge | 4. separate price | 5. saving | 6. eligible item | 7. compulsory charges | 8. alternative | 9. price breakdown | 10. selection

Calculate another cafe offer

F Say it

A different cafe lists a \$7 standard combo and a \$0.75 oat upcharge that still applies. The same items separately total \$9.25. All compulsory charges are included. The muffin is available but not yet accepted.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

7.75 / accepted / 9.25 / 1.50

Counter: "The oat combo total is ¹ _____ dollars."

Customer: "The separate total is ² _____ dollars."

Counter: "The combo saves ³ _____ dollars."

Counter: "The muffin substitution is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. 7.75 | 2. 9.25 | 3. 1.50 | 4. accepted

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

One order, three unfinished items

A Read the situation

Transfer drink, stock, and cash-check responsibilities while preserving the difference between counted, pending, and signed off.

At 2:00, outgoing barista Ellis briefs incoming worker Noor. Ticket 108 contains coffee and tea: the coffee is complete, but the tea is pending. Large takeaway lids are unavailable; small lids remain. Ellis has counted the till, but lead Mara has not completed reconciliation. Noor accepts the tea follow-up and will check replenishment of the correct large lids. Mara retains the till review. No tea completion, large-lid delivery, approved substitute lid, or cash sign-off is established. The handover must keep these separate tasks and stages visible.

PEOPLE / Ellis: Outgoing barista | Noor: Incoming cafe worker

RECEIVING A TASK IS NOT COMPLETING IT

A handover benefits from a short read-back with the order number, outstanding item, and next owner. A colleague can confidently accept responsibility while saying a check remains pending. Do not make the end of a shift sound like every task has ended.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What remains on ticket 108?

- A A new pastry order
- C The tea

- B No item; the whole order is complete
- D The already completed coffee only

2. Which lids are unavailable?

- A Large takeaway lids
- C All lids of every kind

- B Small lids
- D No lids; stock is full

3. What is the till status?

- A Fully signed off
- C Already reconciled by Noor

- B Confirmed short by a stated amount
- D Counted, with Mara's reconciliation pending

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

shift handover

Transfer of current work information between outgoing and incoming staff.

IN USE conduct a shift handover

outgoing worker

Person transferring work at the end of a shift or assignment.

IN USE brief the outgoing worker

incoming worker

Person receiving responsibility for continuing work.

IN USE brief the incoming worker

open ticket

Order record with unfinished items or unresolved work.

IN USE identify an open ticket

item-level status

State of each individual item within an order.

IN USE report item-level status

remaining item

Item still needing completion within a known order.

IN USE name the remaining item

tea follow-up

Responsibility for checking and completing the pending tea through the actual process.

IN USE accept the tea follow-up

takeaway lid

Cover designed for the specified takeaway cup.

IN USE check the takeaway lid

lid size

Size specification relevant to the matching cup.

IN USE confirm the lid size

stockout

Situation in which a required stock item is unavailable.

IN USE report a stockout

replenishment

Restoration of stock through the relevant supply process.

IN USE check replenishment

compatible item

Item verified to fit and function for the intended use.

IN USE verify a compatible item

Precision check

Coffee complete does not mean ticket complete. Till counted does not mean till reconciled. A handover should preserve each item and stage so the incoming worker does not inherit a misleading all-done summary.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

stock follow-up

Task of checking availability or replenishment.

IN USE assign stock follow-up

delivery estimate

Approximate expected arrival time for a supply item.

IN USE verify a delivery estimate

till

Cash drawer or register arrangement used for transactions.

IN USE count the till

cash count

Physical tally of cash held at a stated point.

IN USE record the cash count

reconciliation

Comparison of records and amounts to identify and resolve differences.

IN USE complete reconciliation

expected balance

Amount records indicate should be present.

IN USE compare the expected balance

actual balance

Amount found by the relevant count or measurement.

IN USE record the actual balance

variance

Difference between compared figures.

IN USE investigate a variance

review owner

Person responsible for the pending review.

IN USE name the review owner

sign-off

Required confirmation that a review or process is complete.

IN USE obtain sign-off

pending review

Review not yet completed.

IN USE retain pending-review status

handover read-back

Repetition of transferred tasks and states for confirmation.

IN USE give a handover read-back

Precision check

Small lids remaining do not prove they fit large cups. Report the exact shortage and request the correct replenishment or an approved compatible option through the actual process. Do not promise an arrival time without a checked estimate.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE HANDOVER

"I have three items to hand over at two o'clock."

IDENTIFY THE OPEN ORDER

"Ticket 108 still needs its tea."

SEPARATE COMPLETION

"The coffee is complete; the tea is pending."

ASSIGN THE FOLLOW-UP

"Can you take responsibility for the tea follow-up?"

ACCEPT RESPONSIBILITY

"Yes, I will take that follow-up."

NAME THE SHORTAGE

"Large takeaway lids are unavailable."

KEEP REMAINING STOCK DISTINCT

"Small lids remain, but that does not establish compatibility."

REQUEST REPLENISHMENT

"Please check the correct large-lid stock."

Item versus order

One finished item does not establish completion of the full ticket.

Count versus reconciliation

A count produces an amount; reconciliation compares it with relevant records.

Still pending

This preserves unfinished work through a change of staff.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN ARRIVAL PROMISE

"There is no checked delivery estimate."

PRESERVE THE PENDING STAGE

"Mara's reconciliation is still pending."

AVOID FALSE SIGN-OFF

"I am not reporting the till as signed off."

SEPARATE ACCEPTANCE

"I have accepted the work; I have not completed it yet."

STATE THE CASH STAGE

"The till has been counted."

NAME THE OWNER

"Mara retains the till review."

READ BACK THE TASKS

"Tea follow-up and large-lid check are with me."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Update the records with the actual results as the tasks finish."

08

With me

Common shorthand for responsibility, not proof of completed action.

Correct size

State the needed specification rather than assuming another size works.

Signed off

Use only when the required completion or approval has actually occurred.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover is accurate?

- A** The till is signed off because Ellis counted it.
- B** Ticket 108 is ready because its coffee is complete.
- C** Ticket 108: coffee complete, tea pending; large lids unavailable; till counted, review pending.
- D** Everything is done except some stock.

2. What does Noor's acceptance establish?

- A** Delivered large lids
- B** Mara's completed cash reconciliation
- C** Responsibility for the tea and stock follow-ups
- D** Completed tea service

3. Which stock claim is unsupported?

- A** Small lids are approved substitutes for the large cups.
- B** Large lids are unavailable.
- C** Small lids remain.
- D** Replenishment needs checking.

4. Who owns the pending till review?

- A** The customer with ticket 108
- B** No named person
- C** Mara
- D** Noor by automatic assumption

Answers and explanations: page 90.

One order, three unfinished items

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cash count / shift handover / stock follow-up / tea follow-up / item-level status / stockout / sign-off / handover read-back / review owner / reconciliation

08

- 01 **Ellis:** It is two o'clock, and I need to hand over an open order, a lid shortage, and the till status before I finish.
- 02 **Noor:** I am ready for the ¹ _____. Please take them one at a time so I can keep the customer order separate from stock and cash checks.
- 03 **Ellis:** Ticket one hundred eight has two drinks. The coffee is complete, but the tea is pending. It is not a fully completed order.
- 04 **Noor:** I will record the ² _____ as coffee complete, tea pending. I will not mark the entire ticket complete just because one drink is finished.
- 05 **Ellis:** Can you take the tea follow-up from here? Please use the actual order details and update its status when the work has really been completed.
- 06 **Noor:** Yes, I accept the ³ _____. That is my next responsibility on ticket one hundred eight, not a claim that I have already made the drink.
- 07 **Ellis:** Next, large takeaway lids are unavailable. We still have small lids, but I have not established an approved alternative for the large cups.
- 08 **Noor:** Understood. The ⁴ _____ is for large lids. I will not assume the remaining small ones are compatible with a different cup size.
- 09 **Ellis:** Please check replenishment of the correct large lids. I have no confirmed delivery time to pass on, so do not promise one from this handover.
- 10 **Noor:** I will take the ⁵ _____ and report what I actually find. The need is clear, but the arrival time and supply outcome remain unconfirmed.



The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Ellis:** Finally, I have counted the till. Mara has not completed reconciliation, so the count is available but the review is still pending.
- 12 **Noor:** The ⁶ _____ is complete, while reconciliation is not. I will not turn counted into signed off when I update the next person.
- 13 **Ellis:** Exactly. We have not established a shortage or an overage in this conversation. Mara still needs to carry out the relevant comparison and review.
- 14 **Noor:** I will leave the ⁷ _____ with Mara. There is no reason to invent a difference between actual and expected cash from a pending check.
- 15 **Ellis:** Thank you. Could you repeat who owns each unfinished part? I want to make sure none of the three items disappears when I leave.
- 16 **Noor:** My ⁸ _____ is: I take the tea follow-up and correct large-lid stock check. Mara retains the till review, which remains pending.
- 17 **Ellis:** That is right. Please keep the results separate when they come in. A lid update does not close the tea order or the cash review.
- 18 **Noor:** Agreed. The ⁹ _____ for the till remains Mara. I will record each actual outcome against its own task rather than give one blanket completion message.
- 19 **Ellis:** Good. I can finish my shift knowing the outstanding work has a named owner, without pretending the work itself has already been finished.
- 20 **Noor:** Yes. The handover is clear, but the till has no ¹⁰ _____ yet. I have accepted the tea and stock tasks and will update their real status as I carry them out.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. shift handover | 2. item-level status | 3. tea follow-up | 4. stockout | 5. stock follow-up | 6. cash count | 7. reconciliation | 8. handover read-back | 9. review owner | 10. sign-off

Transfer a different afternoon handover

F Say it

Ticket 205 has tea complete and cocoa pending. Medium lids are unavailable. Incoming worker Jules accepts the cocoa and stock follow-ups. Lead Ben retains the till reconciliation, which is still pending.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

08

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cocoa / Ben / pending / medium

Incoming: "The remaining drink is ¹ _____."

Outgoing: "The missing lid size is ² _____."

Incoming: "The till review remains with ³ _____."

Outgoing: "The till review is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. cocoa | 2. medium | 3. Ben | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Taking a precise drink order

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What does regular mean on this cafe menu?

C. The middle size

The brief defines the local size convention, not a universal coffee meaning.

2. What did Alex initially mean?

D. Non-decaf coffee

Alex uses regular for coffee choice rather than cup size.

3. Which order is confirmed?

D. Small hot non-decaf latte, standard dairy milk, no syrup, takeaway

The separate answers establish every listed detail in the confirmed order.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which question directly resolves the ambiguity?

C. Do you mean our middle size or non-decaf coffee?

The correct question names two plausible meanings without imposing either.

2. Which statement overclaims?

D. Non-decaf tells me the exact caffeine quantity.

Coffee choice alone does not establish an exact caffeine quantity.

3. Which correction preserves Alex's request?

B. Small, not regular size; still non-decaf.

The correction changes the size interpretation without changing the confirmed coffee choice.

4. Why read the order back?

A. To verify the combined choices before preparation

A read-back confirms the details together and lets the customer correct a misunderstanding.

01 Conversation answers

Taking a precise drink order

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. regular. Turn 2. Regular is the ambiguous word; the barista checks its intended meaning before selecting a size.

2. small. Turn 4. Small is the size Alex chooses; regular referred to coffee choice, not the intended cup size.

3. hot or iced. Turn 6. Hot or iced asks about temperature style separately rather than inferring it from size or coffee choice.

4. non-decaf. Turn 8. Non-decaf preserves Alex's clarified coffee choice without claiming a particular caffeine amount.

5. dairy milk. Turn 10. Dairy milk is the stated default product category, which Alex asks the barista to identify.

6. no syrup. Turn 12. No syrup records the explicit omission rather than leaving the bar to infer a default.

7. takeaway. Turn 14. Takeaway confirms the destination Alex supplied at the start, not an invented service arrangement.

8. read-back. Turn 16. A read-back repeats the complete received order so the customer can verify its combined details.

9. size convention. Turn 18. Size convention names the cafe's local labeling system, which is different from Alex's use of regular.

10. order entry. Turn 20. Order entry is the recorded selection now checked with Alex, not proof the drink has already been made.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. decaf

Barista: "The coffee choice is decaf."

Jo explicitly clarifies decaf as the intended coffee choice.

2. large

Customer: "The size should be large."

Large is the selected cup size in this new order.

3. iced

Barista: "The drink should be iced."

Iced is the stated temperature style, not inferred from size.

4. oat drink

Customer: "Please use oat drink."

Oat drink is the specified milk alternative for this order.

02 Briefing and language checks

Comparing drinks without overclaiming

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which feature does Morgan want less of?

D. Foam

The brief identifies less foam as the preference to satisfy.

2. What is the same in both recipes?

B. The espresso serving

Both small drinks use the same espresso serving in this fictional cafe.

3. Which option matches the stated preference?

C. The small latte

The latte has less foam than the cappuccino in the supplied recipes.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which recommendation is best supported?

D. Choose the latte if less foam is your priority.

The supplied recipe comparison directly supports the latte for less foam.

2. Which statement preserves scope?

C. In our small recipes, the espresso serving is the same.

The phrase limits the comparison to the two actual cafe recipes.

3. What should Sora clarify if asked for stronger?

C. Whether Morgan means flavor or caffeine

Strong has several possible meanings that require a specific follow-up question.

4. Which feature is not established?

C. Exact caffeine content in milligrams

No measured caffeine quantity is supplied in the brief or recipe comparison.

02 Conversation answers

02

Comparing drinks without overclaiming

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. less foam.** Turn 2. Less foam is the customer's stated preference and the relevant basis for recommending the latte.
- 2. same espresso serving.** Turn 4. The same espresso serving is the supplied shared feature; the texture difference does not add espresso.
- 3. texture.** Turn 6. Texture names how the drink feels, which is the comparison Morgan is asking about.
- 4. stronger.** Turn 8. Stronger is ambiguous between perceived flavor and caffeine; it needs clarification rather than a single assumed meaning.
- 5. shot count.** Turn 10. Shot count identifies the espresso-serving quantity, which Morgan does not want increased.
- 6. like-for-like.** Turn 12. Like-for-like keeps the comparison on the two specified small drinks rather than mixing different sizes or cafes.
- 7. milk proportion.** Turn 14. Milk proportion describes the milk share of the recipe and helps explain the difference without changing the espresso serving.
- 8. preference.** Turn 16. Preference is the customer's expressed desire for less foam, not a medical need or universal quality ranking.
- 9. recipe variation.** Turn 18. Recipe variation allows for different formulations across cafes; these examples do not define universal drink proportions.
- 10. extra shot.** Turn 20. Extra shot names the additional espresso serving Morgan explicitly does not request.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. cappuccino

Barista: "The closer match is the cappuccino."

The cappuccino has more foam, matching Rei's stated preference.

2. foam

Customer: "I want more foam, not more coffee."

Foam is the feature Rei wants increased in the comparison.

3. one

Barista: "Both small recipes use one espresso serving."

One espresso serving is the shared recipe quantity supplied.

4. extra shot

Customer: "Please do not add an extra shot."

Rei explicitly declines an additional espresso serving beyond the recipe.

03 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which allergy is reported?

B. Milk

Priya explicitly reports a milk allergy, separate from the syrup omission.

2. What has Leo verified so far?

A. Oat drink is available

Availability is known, while ingredient and preparation checks remain incomplete.

3. Who can review the request?

C. Amina, the shift lead

Amina is the named available lead for the cafe allergy procedure.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which response is best?

C. We have oat drink, but I need to check the product and preparation for your milk allergy.

The answer separates stock availability from ingredient and preparation suitability.

2. What does no vanilla establish?

D. A request to omit that syrup

The omission concerns one ingredient and does not settle the full allergy question.

3. Which summary should reach Amina?

C. Oat latte, no vanilla, reported milk allergy; relevant checks pending

The summary preserves all known details and the unresolved checking status.

4. Which claim is unsupported?

B. The complete drink is suitable for Priya's allergy.

Neither current product information nor preparation arrangements have yet been verified.

03 Conversation answers

Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. milk allergy.** Turn 2. Milk allergy is the reported safety-related information, separate from the customer's syrup preference.
- 2. availability.** Turn 4. Availability means the product is present; it does not establish suitability for the reported allergy.
- 3. ingredient list.** Turn 6. The ingredient list supplies product composition information for the actual carton rather than assumptions from its name.
- 4. shared equipment.** Turn 8. Shared equipment is relevant because preparation can introduce allergens even when a product name sounds suitable.
- 5. omission.** Turn 10. Omission refers to leaving out vanilla syrup, a separate instruction that does not resolve the milk-allergy question.
- 6. shift lead.** Turn 12. The shift lead is the named available person who can review the request through the cafe process.
- 7. allergy flag.** Turn 14. The allergy flag preserves the disclosure as allergy-related information rather than reducing it to a preference.
- 8. suitability.** Turn 16. Suitability is the unresolved question about the complete product and preparation, not merely whether oat drink is stocked.
- 9. customer update.** Turn 18. A customer update communicates the review result or continuing uncertainty without implying that a pending check is complete.
- 10. allergy procedure.** Turn 20. The allergy procedure is the actual workplace route for the request; this conversation does not substitute for its required checks.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. sesame

Barista: "The reported allergy is sesame."

Sesame is explicitly reported and must not be replaced by soy.

2. caramel

Customer: "Please leave out caramel."

Caramel is the separate omission requested for this drink.

3. Rosa

Barista: "The lead available to review this is Rosa."

Rosa is the named available reviewer in the new scenario.

4. unconfirmed

Barista: "Suitability remains unconfirmed."

Both relevant checks are incomplete, so suitability cannot be asserted.

04 Briefing and language checks

Managing the queue and pickup

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which ticket belongs to this Sam?

C. 67

The brief explicitly identifies this customer as holding ticket 67.

2. Which drink is complete?

C. Ticket 64, small hot latte

Ticket 64 is complete while the other drink remains in progress.

3. What wait can Hana promise?

B. No precise wait is established

The brief provides no reliable estimate for completion of ticket 67.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which call is least ambiguous?

D. Sam, ticket 64, small hot latte

The number and description distinguish two orders with the same customer name.

2. Which status report is correct?

A. Ticket 64 is complete; ticket 67 is in progress.

The report preserves the separately established preparation states.

3. Which response invents a fact?

D. Yours will definitely be ready in thirty seconds.

No reliable completion estimate is supplied, so thirty seconds is unsupported.

4. Why check before collection?

C. The name alone does not distinguish the orders.

Both customers share a name, requiring additional order details to match correctly.

04 Conversation answers

Managing the queue and pickup

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. ticket number.** Turn 2. The ticket number distinguishes the two customers sharing the name Sam before the drink is collected.
- 2. sixty-four.** Turn 4. Sixty-four identifies the finished small hot latte, not Sam's large iced decaf order.
- 3. drink description.** Turn 6. The drink description adds size, temperature, and coffee choice to the ticket identifier, making the match clearer.
- 4. in progress.** Turn 8. In progress is the verified unfinished preparation state of ticket 67; it is not a ready-for-collection announcement.
- 5. estimated wait.** Turn 10. An estimated wait requires a current check; Hana has no reliable time to give at this point.
- 6. ready call.** Turn 12. The ready call will identify the specific completed order, reducing the ambiguity caused by a shared name.
- 7. completed drink.** Turn 14. The completed drink is ticket 64's small hot latte; it remains separate from the pending ticket 67.
- 8. cup label.** Turn 16. The cup label carries the order details; the check confirms the requested decaf modifier remains attached to ticket 67.
- 9. handover point.** Turn 18. The handover point is where the final match matters before the prepared drink passes to the customer.
- 10. pickup mix-up.** Turn 20. The pickup mix-up concerns identity at collection; resolving it does not mean the pending drink has become ready.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 84

Barista: "Your ticket number is 84."

The customer in this exchange holds ticket 84, not 81.

2. coffee

Customer: "I ordered the large iced coffee."

Coffee is the drink attached to ticket 84 in the brief.

3. 81

Barista: "The completed small tea belongs to ticket 81."

Ticket 81 identifies the completed tea, a separate order.

4. in progress

Barista: "Your order remains in progress."

Ticket 84 has not reached completion in the supplied facts.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Handling remakes and mistaken labels

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What does ticket 22 request?

D. Small iced latte with no syrup

The ticket gives the intended size, temperature, and syrup omission.

2. What is wrong with the cup label?

C. It says hot vanilla latte

Hot and vanilla conflict with iced and no syrup on the ticket.

3. Which outcome is not established?

C. A checked remake wait

A remake is available, but nobody has checked its current wait.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which request preserves the order?

D. Remake ticket 22 as a small iced latte with no syrup.

The request preserves every supplied order detail and asks for a real remake.

2. Which statement should Ben avoid?

A. Your replacement will definitely be ready in one minute.

No checked wait or guaranteed completion time has been supplied.

3. What does a corrected label alone establish?

A. Corrected wording, not verified drink contents

Relabeling changes information and does not verify preparation or contents.

4. Which report avoids blame?

A. The ticket and cup label do not match.

The evidence establishes a mismatch but does not identify intent or cause.

05 Conversation answers

Handling remakes and mistaken labels

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. source ticket.** Turn 2. The source ticket is the order record used to establish the intended drink rather than trusting the conflicting label.
- 2. mismatch.** Turn 4. Mismatch describes the disagreement between iced and no syrup on the ticket and hot vanilla on the label.
- 3. remake.** Turn 6. A remake means preparing a replacement to match the order, not merely changing the label on an unchecked drink.
- 4. order specification.** Turn 8. The order specification includes all confirmed details: small, iced, latte, and no syrup.
- 5. checked estimate.** Turn 10. A checked estimate comes from current production information; no reliable remake wait has yet been obtained.
- 6. customer-facing message.** Turn 12. The customer-facing message explains the correction and unresolved timing in ordinary language without inventing a promise.
- 7. refund.** Turn 14. Refund is a separate payment decision; the availability of a remake does not establish authorization to return money.
- 8. cause.** Turn 16. Cause requires evidence beyond the observed disagreement; the exchange does not establish who or what produced the error.
- 9. final match.** Turn 18. The final match verifies the replacement against the intended order before handover, rather than assuming a new cup is automatically correct.
- 10. remake status.** Turn 20. Remake status reports the actual stage of the replacement; it must not convert an intended correction into completed work.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. hot

Counter: "The intended temperature is hot."

Hot is the ticket instruction, while iced is the conflicting label.

2. oat drink

Barista: "The specified milk alternative is oat drink."

Oat drink is the confirmed product choice on ticket 35.

3. no syrup

Counter: "The ticket also requests no syrup."

The syrup omission must remain intact while correcting the other details.

4. unchecked

Barista: "The current wait is still unchecked."

No verified remake estimate is supplied in the new scenario.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Discussing coffee beans for home

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What information is missing?

D. The recipient's brewer and grinder availability

The customer does not know the brewing equipment or whether a grinder is available.

2. What does hazelnut mean on this bag?

C. A flavor note, not an ingredient declaration

The brief explicitly defines the wording as a sensory description.

3. What should happen before choosing a grind?

A. Clarify the intended brewing method

The brewing method is needed to choose a relevant grind rather than guessing.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which response to normal ground is strongest?

A. What brewer will the recipient use?

The brewer supplies the missing context needed for a useful grind choice.

2. What can Rafael infer from hazelnut alone?

B. A stated sensory description, not ingredient or allergy status

Tasting language does not establish product composition, handling, or recipient equipment.

3. Why not automatically recommend whole beans?

D. The recipient may not have a suitable grinder.

Grinder availability is unknown, so convenience cannot be assumed.

4. Which statement preserves the decision stage?

C. The grind choice has not been finalized.

Neither the intended brewer nor a final grind choice is established.

06 Conversation answers

Discussing coffee beans for home

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. brewing method.** Turn 2. Brewing method supplies the intended use needed to clarify the ambiguous request for normal ground coffee.
- 2. brewer.** Turn 4. Brewer is the equipment Rafael needs identified; simply knowing a machine exists does not establish its type.
- 3. grind size.** Turn 6. Grind size is the particle-size choice that should be established before the irreversible grinding step.
- 4. whole bean.** Turn 8. Whole bean describes the unground product option, which preserves a later grinding choice but requires suitable equipment to use.
- 5. grind setting.** Turn 10. Grind setting remains undecided because the recipient's equipment is unknown; Rafael must not invent a default.
- 6. tasting note.** Turn 12. Tasting note names the sensory wording on this bag; it is not presented as an added ingredient.
- 7. ingredient declaration.** Turn 14. An ingredient declaration concerns product contents, while a tasting note concerns sensory perception.
- 8. allergen suitability.** Turn 16. Allergen suitability cannot be inferred either positively or negatively from the sensory word hazelnut alone.
- 9. brewer type.** Turn 18. Brewer type gives concrete equipment context for discussing a suitable grind rather than treating normal as a universal setting.
- 10. purchase choice.** Turn 20. Purchase choice remains open; pausing grinding is not the same as completing a whole-bean sale.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. French press

Customer: "The recipient uses a French press."

French press is the confirmed brewer in this new scenario.

2. brewer

Barista: "We should match the grind to that brewer."

The equipment provides the relevant basis for the grind discussion.

3. flavor note

Customer: "Cocoa here is a flavor note."

The brief identifies cocoa as sensory wording on the bag.

4. assessment

Barista: "That wording is not an allergy assessment."

A flavor description does not supply a completed allergy assessment.

07 Briefing and language checks

Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What is the oat combo price?

D. \$6.50

The \$6 combo still carries the specified \$0.50 oat upcharge.

2. What would the same selected items cost separately?

C. \$7.50

Four dollars plus fifty cents plus three dollars equals seven dollars fifty.

3. Which pastry is available?

A. The eligible plain pastry

The brief distinguishes the sold-out almond pastry from the available plain option.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which calculation is correct?

B. \$6 + \$0.50 = \$6.50

The oat charge is added to the combo's six-dollar base.

2. How much less is the combo than separate purchase?

D. \$1.00

Seven dollars fifty minus six dollars fifty equals one dollar.

3. Which statement wrongly treats an offer as acceptance?

D. I have charged you for the plain pastry because almond is sold out.

Availability does not establish the customer's agreement to the alternative.

4. Why mention charge inclusion?

D. To keep this transaction's stated comparison complete

The brief explicitly includes compulsory charges, so the comparison can use the supplied totals.

07 Conversation answers

Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. sold out. Turn 2. Sold out describes the requested pastry's current unavailability, which must be disclosed before offering another item.

2. combo. Turn 4. Combo names the six-dollar package containing the standard latte and one eligible pastry.

3. upcharge. Turn 6. Upcharge is the additional fifty cents that applies both to the combo and to the separately purchased latte.

4. separate price. Turn 8. The separate price adds the four-dollar latte, fifty-cent oat variation, and three-dollar pastry, totaling seven dollars fifty.

5. saving. Turn 10. Saving is the one-dollar difference between the same selected items bought as a combo or separately.

6. eligible item. Turn 12. Eligible item means the available plain pastry qualifies for the stated combo rather than being excluded from the promotion.

7. compulsory charges. Turn 14. Compulsory charges are explicitly included in this fictional transaction, making the stated comparison complete for these choices.

8. alternative. Turn 16. Alternative names a possible replacement; it is not an accepted selection until the customer chooses it.

9. price breakdown. Turn 18. Price breakdown separates the six-dollar combo base from the fifty-cent oat addition, producing the stated six-fifty total.

10. selection. Turn 20. Selection is the customer's actual choice, still needed before treating the proposed plain-pastry combo as the agreed transaction.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. 7.75

Counter: "The oat combo total is 7.75 dollars."

Seven dollars plus seventy-five cents gives seven dollars seventy-five.

2. 9.25

Customer: "The separate total is 9.25 dollars."

Nine dollars twenty-five is the separate total supplied in the brief.

3. 1.50

Counter: "The combo saves 1.50 dollars."

Nine dollars twenty-five minus seven dollars seventy-five equals one dollar fifty.

4. accepted

Counter: "The muffin substitution is not yet accepted."

Availability does not show agreement, and acceptance remains pending here.

08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over the bar and till

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What remains on ticket 108?

C. The tea

The coffee is complete but the tea is explicitly still pending.

2. Which lids are unavailable?

A. Large takeaway lids

The shortage is specific to large takeaway lids, while small lids remain.

3. What is the till status?

D. Counted, with Mara's reconciliation pending

A count is complete, but the separate reconciliation has not been completed.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Ticket 108: coffee complete, tea pending; large lids unavailable; till counted, review pending.

The complete report preserves each task and its distinct current stage.

2. What does Noor's acceptance establish?

C. Responsibility for the tea and stock follow-ups

Accepting a task transfers responsibility but does not perform the task.

3. Which stock claim is unsupported?

A. Small lids are approved substitutes for the large cups.

Remaining stock alone does not establish fit, suitability, or substitution approval.

4. Who owns the pending till review?

C. Mara

The brief explicitly leaves the reconciliation review with lead Mara.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over the bar and till

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. shift handover. Turn 2. Shift handover transfers current tasks and information; it does not imply that every outgoing task is finished.

2. item-level status. Turn 4. Item-level status distinguishes the completed coffee from the pending tea within the same ticket.

3. tea follow-up. Turn 6. Tea follow-up is the specific outstanding responsibility Noor accepts; accepting it does not establish the tea is ready.

4. stockout. Turn 8. Stockout concerns the specified large lids, not every lid or a confirmed suitable substitute.

5. stock follow-up. Turn 10. Stock follow-up assigns checking of the correct replenishment; no delivery or arrival estimate is yet confirmed.

6. cash count. Turn 12. Cash count is the completed tally, which must remain distinct from the uncompleted reconciliation against relevant records.

7. reconciliation. Turn 14. Reconciliation is the comparison and review that Mara has not completed; the handover supplies no resulting variance.

8. handover read-back. Turn 16. The handover read-back confirms both responsibility and unfinished status, reducing the chance that an open task is lost.

9. review owner. Turn 18. Review owner identifies Mara as responsible for the cash review; Noor's other accepted tasks do not transfer that review automatically.

10. sign-off. Turn 20. Sign-off is the required completed confirmation, which cannot be inferred from a cash count or a successful handover.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. cocoa

Incoming: "The remaining drink is cocoa."

Cocoa is pending, while the tea is already complete.

2. medium

Outgoing: "The missing lid size is medium."

Medium is the specific shortage supplied in this new handover.

3. Ben

Incoming: "The till review remains with Ben."

Ben is explicitly identified as the owner of reconciliation.

4. pending

Outgoing: "The till review is still pending."

No completed reconciliation or sign-off is established in this handover.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Taking a precise drink order

Resolve the first word: When you say regular, do you mean size or non-decaf?

Separate temperature: Would you like that hot or iced?

Check destination: Is that for here or to take away?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Comparing drinks without overclaiming

Name the comparison: Are you comparing our small latte and small cappuccino?

Explain the cappuccino: Our small cappuccino has more foam.

Separate features: Foam and caffeine are different questions.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

Acknowledge the allergy: Thank you for telling me about your milk allergy.

Separate suitability: Availability does not confirm suitability for your allergy.

Involve the lead: I will ask Amina to review this through our allergy procedure.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Managing the queue and pickup

Interrupt briefly: One moment, please; let me check the ticket.

Name the shared-name issue: We have two orders under Sam.

Use both identifiers: I will call the number and drink as well as the name.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38



Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Handling remakes and mistaken labels

Identify the order: I need a correction for ticket 22.

Protect the modifiers: Iced and no syrup both need to stay on the replacement.

Acknowledge the issue: I see the mismatch.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Discussing coffee beans for home

Ask about use: How will the recipient brew the coffee?

Ask for equipment: Do you know the brewer name or type?

Keep the options clear: We sell this coffee whole or ground.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

Explain the shortage: The almond pastry is sold out.

State the base offer: The standard latte-and-pastry combo is six dollars.

Explain the saving: The combo is one dollar less for those same items.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over the bar and till

Open the handover: I have three items to hand over at two o'clock.

Assign the follow-up: Can you take responsibility for the tea follow-up?

Request replenishment: Please check the correct large-lid stock.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acknowledgement give an acknowledgement	42
actual balance record the actual balance	69
advisory statement read the advisory statement	24
aeration describe milk aeration	15
allergen identify the reported allergen	23
allergy flag preserve the allergy flag	24
allergy procedure follow the allergy procedure	23
apology offer an apology	42
aroma describe the aroma	51
availability confirm availability	24
available alternative offer an available alternative	60
barista ask the barista	5
base price state the base price	59
blade grinder identify a blade grinder	51
blend describe a blend	51
body describe the body	14
brewer identify the brewer	50
brewing method clarify the brewing method	50
burr grinder use a burr grinder	50
caffeine content avoid guessing caffeine content	14
cappuccino compare the cappuccino	14
cash count record the cash count	69
cause avoid guessing the cause	42
checked estimate give a checked estimate	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

checkout total confirm the checkout total	60
clarifying question ask a clarifying question	6
coarse grind request a coarse grind	51
cold brew distinguish cold brew	50
collection confirm before collection	32
collection check complete the collection check	33
combined price state the combined price	59
combo explain the combo	59
compatible item verify a compatible item	68
completed drink identify the completed drink	32
complimentary item authorize a complimentary item	42
compulsory charge include compulsory charges	60
concentration distinguish concentration from serving amount	15
contains statement review the contains statement	24
correction request send a correction request	42
crema distinguish crema from milk foam	15
cross-contact assess cross-contact	23
cup label read the cup label	32
cup size clarify the cup size	5
current carton check the current carton	23
customer acceptance obtain customer acceptance	60
customer update give a customer update	24
customer-facing message prepare a customer-facing message	42
dairy milk specify dairy milk	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

decaf request decaf	5
delivery estimate verify a delivery estimate	69
displayed price verify the displayed price	60
drink description repeat the drink description	32
drink order confirm the drink order	5
drip brewer use a drip brewer	50
duplicate name resolve a duplicate name	32
eligible item confirm an eligible item	59
entry error investigate an entry error	41
espresso prepare espresso	5
espresso machine identify an espresso machine	50
espresso serving use the same espresso serving	14
estimated wait check the estimated wait	33
expected balance compare the expected balance	69
extra shot request an extra shot	15
extraction discuss extraction	15
final match confirm the final match	42
fine grind request a fine grind	51
flavor intensity compare flavor intensity	14
foam reduce the foam	14
food allergy report a food allergy	23
for here ask for here or to go	6
French press identify a French press	50
gift recipient ask about the gift recipient	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

grind setting	confirm the grind setting	50
grind size	match the grind size	50
ground coffee	buy ground coffee	50
handover point	check at the handover point	33
handover read-back	give a handover read-back	69
hot	confirm hot or iced	5
iced	make an iced latte	5
identifier	use a second identifier	33
in progress	mark the order in progress	32
included item	name the included items	59
incoming worker	brief the incoming worker	68
incorrect label	correct an incorrect label	41
ingredient declaration	check the ingredient declaration	51
ingredient list	check the ingredient list	23
ingredient verification	complete ingredient verification	24
item-level status	report item-level status	68
itemized receipt	provide an itemized receipt	60
latte	order a latte	5
lid size	confirm the lid size	68
like-for-like	make a like-for-like comparison	15
liquid milk	compare liquid milk	14
microfoam	describe microfoam	14
milk allergy	communicate a milk allergy	23
milk pitcher	identify the milk pitcher	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

milk proportion	compare the milk proportion	14
milk protein	identify milk proteins	24
mismatch	identify a mismatch	41
modifier	enter the modifier	6
mouthfeel	describe the mouthfeel	14
non-decaf	specify non-decaf coffee	5
oat drink	check the oat drink	24
omission	record the omission	24
open ticket	identify an open ticket	68
optional addition	confirm an optional addition	59
order entry	check the order entry	6
order match	verify the order match	32
order name	call the order name	32
order specification	preserve the order specification	41
origin	check the coffee origin	51
outgoing worker	brief the outgoing worker	68
partial order	identify a partial order	33
particle size	compare particle size	51
payment authorization	obtain payment authorization	60
pending item	identify the pending item	33
pending review	retain pending-review status	69
pickup counter	wait at the pickup counter	32
pickup mix-up	prevent a pickup mix-up	33
plant-based drink	check a plant-based drink	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

point of sale check the point of sale	60
polite interruption use a polite interruption	33
pour-over prepare a pour-over	50
preference match the preference	15
preparation arrangement verify preparation arrangements	23
preparation start confirm before preparation start	6
preparation status check preparation status	33
price breakdown give a price breakdown	59
price difference calculate the price difference	59
product formulation verify the product formulation	23
production error investigate a production error	41
promotion terms check the promotion terms	60
queue manage the queue	32
queue position explain queue position	33
queue priority confirm queue priority	42
read-back give a read-back	6
readiness confirm readiness	33
ready call make a clear ready call	32
recipe basis state the recipe basis	15
recipe variation allow for recipe variation	15
reconciliation complete reconciliation	69
refund request a refund review	42
regular clarify regular	5
relabeling distinguish relabeling from remaking	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

remaining item name the remaining item	68
remake request a remake	41
remake status update remake status	42
replacement arrange a replacement	41
replenishment check replenishment	68
review owner name the review owner	69
roast level describe the roast level	51
saving explain the saving	59
separate purchase compare a separate purchase	59
service recovery coordinate service recovery	42
shared equipment check shared equipment	23
shift handover conduct a shift handover	68
shift lead consult the shift lead	23
shot confirm the shot count	5
shot count confirm the shot count	14
sign-off obtain sign-off	69
single origin clarify single origin	51
size convention explain the size convention	6
small order a small latte	5
small size compare the small size	15
sold out mark the pastry sold out	60
source ticket check the source ticket	41
standalone price compare the standalone price	59
standard milk identify the standard milk	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

steam wand	identify the steam wand	15
stock follow-up	assign stock follow-up	69
stock status	update the stock status	60
stockout	report a stockout	68
substitution	confirm a substitution	60
suitability	avoid assuming suitability	24
supplier change	check after a supplier change	23
syrup	omit the syrup	6
syrup omission	preserve the syrup omission	41
takeaway	mark as takeaway	6
takeaway lid	check the takeaway lid	68
tasting note	explain a tasting note	51
tea follow-up	accept the tea follow-up	68
temperature modifier	check the temperature modifier	41
texture	compare the texture	14
ticket number	confirm the ticket number	32
till	count the till	69
time promise	avoid an unsupported time promise	33
unverified	mark suitability unverified	24
upcharge	apply the oat upcharge	59
vanilla syrup	omit vanilla syrup	24
variance	investigate a variance	69
verification	complete verification	41
whole bean	choose whole bean	50

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] National Coffee Association. Espresso.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for espresso equipment, brewing-method vocabulary, and the distinction between flavor concentration and caffeine per serving. No universal cafe recipe is imposed. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] National Coffee Association. Pour-over Coffee.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for whole beans, grinding, brewing methods, and matching grind to the intended brewer. Workplace instructions remain controlling. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] World Coffee Research. Sensory Lexicon.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for sensory descriptions of coffee flavor, aroma, and texture. No flavor wheel or lexicon text is reproduced. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] US Food and Drug Administration. Food Allergies.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for allergen and cross-contact terminology. A drink name or omitted syrup does not establish suitability for an allergy. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

All cafes, recipes, tickets, prices, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not food-safety certification, medical advice, equipment operation, or cash-control procedures. Follow actual product information, local requirements, workplace allergen controls, equipment instructions, and payment rules. No example authorizes serving an unverified drink or bypassing a required check.

English Ladder | English for Work | 2026 edition. The B2-C1 range is an editorial study recommendation, not a proficiency certification.

[Open the matching English Ladder course](#)